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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

FEBRUARY 11, 2025

>> I THINK WE'RE GOING TO GET STARTED, FOLKS IF YOU COULD PLEASE TAKE YOUR SEATS. ALL RIGHT. I DON'T HAVE THE AGENDA IN FRONT OF ME. BUT ALL RIGHT. I'M GOING TO CALL THIS SPECIAL MEETING TO ORDER. IT'S TUESDAY FEBRUARY 11TH AND I WOULD LIKE TO START WITH THE ROLL, PLEASE.

>> OKAY. PRESENT.

>> B. BLACKABY: HERE.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: HERE.

>> A. ISHI: HERE.

>> THIS IS A SPECIAL MEETING. SO I'M GOING TO PASS IT OVER TO CHIEF.

>> THANK YOU VERY MUCH. GOOD EVENING, MAYOR, COUNCIL AND RESIDENTS. THE EVENTS OF LAST MONTH IN LA WERE HEART BREAKING. MOST US -- WE SPENT THE LAST MONTH WORKING WITH MANY STAKEHOLDERS TO PREPARE FOR TONIGHT'S PRESENTATION. THE PYRE FIRES IN LA.

>> AND LEAVING IN THEIR WAKE ENVIRONMENTAL AND FINANCIAL

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DISASTER. THESE EVENTS WERE PREDICTABLE. AS WERE THE FIRES IN PARADISE, AND MANY OTHERS. KNOT JUST PREDICTABLE. IN MANY CASES THESE FIRES HAVE OCCURRED IN SIMILAR AREAS BEFORE. FIRES BURN ALONG PREDICTABLE AND KNOWN TOPOGRAPHICAL FEATURES WITH THE RIGHT MIX OF FUEL. MANY FORCES OF NATURE -- SORRY. LIKE MANY FORCES OF NATURE, WE CANNOT PREVENT FIRES FROM BURNING. FIRE RAN THROUGH THIS LAND ON A REOCCURRING CYCLE EVERY FIVE TO 10 YEARS FOR MILLENNIA. AND BEFORE WE MOVE AED INTO FIRE PRONE AREAS AND FILLED IT WITH HAZARDOUS VEGETATION. WE CAN HOWEVER, LEARN TO LIVE WITH FIRE. BY IMPLEMENTING WHILE UNDERSTOOD. THROUGH WHICH WE CREATE A FIRE ADAPTED COMMUNITY. THESE STEPS WILL DRAMATICALLY REDUCE LOSS OF PROPERTY AND LIFE. WHILE THERE WILL CONTINUE TO BE A PLACE FOR FIRE SUPPRESSION OUR EFFORTS TO REMOVE FIRE FROM THE LANDSCAPE HAVE FAILED. IT WILL TAKE AN ALL-HANDS APPROACH TO BE MORE FIRE SAFE.

>> IF THE PHOTO YOU SEE HERE A TREE THAT HAD EXPERIENCED FIRE ABOUT EVERY 10 YEARS. ENDING AROUND THE TURN OF THE CENTURY. AT WHICH POINT WE SYSTEMICALLY EXCLUDED FIRE FROM THE LANDSCAPE. WHILE THE FIRE TODAY IS PARTIALLY AS CLIMATE CHANGE IT'S ALSO THE RESULT OF THIS SYSTEMIC EXCLUSION OF FIRE FROM THE LANDSCAPE FOR OVER 100 YEARS. THIS ALONG WITH OUR DEVELOPMENT IN THE FIRE PRONE AREAS INCLUDING THE EAST BAY HILLS LED TO A SUBSTANTIAL INCREASE IN FUEL READY TO BURN. AS THE CLIMATE -- MAKING IT

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TENDER DRY. AS THE RAINY SEASON COMPRESSES. WE HAVE TINDER DRY WITH HIGH WIND EVENTS.

>> BECAUSE WE ARE NOT GOING TO ENGAGE IN A MANAGE RETREAT OF THE HILLS WE'RE FACED WITH A BINARY DECISION. TO ADAPT OR NOT. WHEN WE BUILT IN THE EAST BAY HILLS WE WERE UNDER THE MISGUIDED UNDERSTANDING THAT WE COULD CONTROL NATURE. CLEARLY WE CANNOT. WE NEED TO ADAPT OR CONTINUE TO SUFFER THE CONSEQUENCES. MAINTAINING THE STATUS QUO WILL CONTINUE TO RESULT IN SIMILAR OUTCOMES. ALL THESE FIRES AND MANY MORE TOOK ADVANTAGE OF KEY VULNERABILITIES RESULTING IN CATASTROPHIC LOSS, INJURY AND DEATH. THESE VULNERABILITIES ARE WELL KNOWN, SCIENTIFICALLY SUPPORTED AND FIELD TESTED. MANY WITH SIMILAR. OUR STATE EXPERIENCES OVER 8,000 WILDFIRES A YEAR. WE KNOW THAT FIRE WILL INEVITABLY IMPACT BERKELEY HILLS AGAIN. AS IT HAS EVERY 20 YEARS. WITH THE LAST MAJOR EVENT OCCURRING IN 19991 ALMOST 30 YEARS AGO. IF YOU CAN CONCEPTUALIZE THE DESIRED IN STATE AS AN EQUATION. IT MIGHT LOOK LIKE THIS. WITH THREE MAJOR CATEGORIES OF WORK THAT NEED TO OCCUR IN ORDER TO HAVE THE BEST CHAINS OF MINIMIZING FIRE LOSS. UNDER WINDS AND FIRE CONDITIONS WILL NOT STOP THIS TYPE OF FIRE. WE CAN REDUCE THE LOSS. THE ACTIONS THAT NEED TO OCCUR AHEAD OF FIRE WEATHER HAS TO DO WITH DISRUPTING THE FUEL PATH AND DISPENSING HOME HARDENING ON AND AROUND OUR HOMES. AND ENSURING THE FIRE DEPARTMENT IS PROPERLY STAFFED. THE

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NEXT IS WHEN FIRE WEATHER IS FORECAST. UNDER THIS PART OF THE EQUATION WE NEED TO STUDY THE WEATHER, WORK WITH PARTNERS AT THE NATIONAL WEATHER SERVICE AND ISSUE FIRE WEATHER WARNINGS. THEY SIGNIFY THE WORST OF THE WORSE. WE ASK RESIDENTS TO LEAVE THE HILLS EARLY BECAUSE WE KNOW THAT OUR INFRASTRUCTURE WILL NOT SUPPORT A MASSIVE EVACUATION. AND FINELY, WHEN FIRE WEATHER IS FORECAST THERE'S UP STAFFING IN OUR DEPARTMENT AND REGION. THE FIRST COMPONENT IS EARLY DETECTION. DRIVES EARLY ALERTING TO THE COMMUNITY SO THE COMMUNITY HAS THE MOST TIME POSSIBLE TO EVACUATE.

>> ALL OF THIS GIVES US THE BEST CHANCE OF MINIMIZING FIRE LOSS. SO, TO SUMMARIZE WHAT WE'RE GOING TO GET INTO TONIGHT HOW TO MOVE FORWARD AT A HIGH LEVEL. WE WANT TO FOCUS OUR EFFORTS ON TWO STRATEGIC AREAS. IN THESE AREAS WE WANT TO REMOVE ADOPT ZONE ZERO. REMOVING ALL COMBUSTIBLE MATERIAL WITHIN FIVE FEET OF STRUCTURES. AND ALIGN OLDER BUILDING STOCK WITH THE MODERN BUILDING CODE AND FINALLY, THERE'S AN ITEM FROM COUNCIL TO ALSO REFER TO US TO BRING FORWARD PARKING RESTRICTIONS TO BE PART OF THE SAFE PACKAGES PROGRAMS -- PASSAGES PROGRAMS IN THESE AREAS. I WILL HAND IT TO RETIRED FIRE CHIEF TO TALK MORE ABOUT THE WHY BEHIND ALL THESE PROPOSALS.

>> THANK YOU.

>> THE RELATIVE VALUE OF RISK MEASURE. THIS ISN'T A MATTER OF

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WILDFIRE PREVENTION. IT'S BENEFICIAL TO THE LANDS ESCAPE. IT'S THE DISCUSSION OF THE VALUE [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> OKAY. NEXT SLIDE.

>> SO WE RAN A MODEL [INDISCERNIBLE] EXERCISE WHERE WE TOOK THE WEATHER CONDITIONS ASSOCIATED WITH THE DABLO WEATHER EVENT. WIND EVENTS THAT OCCUR AFTER A DRYING PERIOD. SO THIS FOLLOWING SEVERAL WEEKS OF DRY WEATHER. DESICCATED LOW LIFE -- WHICH WE SAW IN 1993 AND 1991. WE RAN A SERIES OF IGNITION LINES TO THE NORTH AND NORTHEAST OF THE COMMUNITY AND LOOKED FOR THE PATH OF LEAST RESISTANCE. THE MINIMAL TRAVEL TIME. THE COMBINATION OF TOPOGRAPHY, WEATHER AND FUEL AS WELL AS THE ASSOCIATED EMBER WATCH

>> SPARKS FIRE, BRANDS, EMBERS ARE CARRIED ALOFT AND BLOWN FORWARD BY THE DOMINATE WINDS. ONCE WE UNDERSTAND THOSE PATHWAYS WE CAN MODEL THE ENTRY POINTS. THOSE ARE SHOWN IN THE PICTURE YOU SEE AS THE SHADED AREAS IN THE COMMUNITY. THAT WOULD BE WHERE A FIRE PATHWAY TERMINATES INTO THE BUILT ENVIRONMENT AND HAS THE POTENTIAL, WHEN IT ENCOUNTERS VULNERABILITIES. A LACK OF DEFENSIBLE FACE THAT SETS CONDITIONS FOR THAT WILDFIRE FROM A VEGETATIVE FIRE TO STRUCTURE. WHEN STRUCTURES ARE WITHIN 50 FEET OF OTHERS WE HAVE POTENTIAL FOR URBAN -- THE DIRECT SPREAD FROM ONE HOME TO ANOTHER. WHAT'S SO IMPORTANT FROM VEGETATION FIRE TO

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URBAN? THE MITIGATIONS WE KNOW ARE EXTRAORDINARILY EFFECTIVE FROM PREVENTING A WILDFIRE ARE INADEQUATE FOR PREVENTING A STRUCTURE-TO-STRUCTURE FIRE. WE'VE EXCEEDED THOSE LIMITATIONS OF THAT LITIGATION. AWAY WE'RE REMMING IS TO -- RECOMMENDING TO HARDEN INDEFENSIBLE SPACE AT THOSE POINTS OF ENTRY THAT CAN INITIATE THE STRUCTURE FIRE. IT'S TRUE EMBERS WILL FLY OVER DEEP IN THE COMMUNITY. THAT'S -- IF ALL OF THE FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES ARE NOT -- EMBER DECAY IS NORMAL. THE DISTANCE OF THE TARGET FROM THE STRUCTURE OF THE SOURCE MATTERS BECAUSE THE NUMBER OF EMBERS TRANSPORTED DROP OFF. ONE EMBER POSES A LOW RISK. IMAGINE TRYING TO LIGHT A HOUSE ON FIRE WITH A BOOK OF MATCHES FIVE FEET FROM THE HOUSE AND FLICK THEM AT THE HOUSE. IT WOULD TAKE TIME. THE GOAL IS TO REDUCE THE VULNERABILITIES IS EMBERS CANNICS EXPLOIT. THIS WAS MENTIONED IN 2008. THE FIRE FIGHTING RESOURCES ARE OVERWHELMED AND BECOME INFECTIVE OR THERE'S MORE FIRE THAN FIRE FIGHTERS AT THE CRITICAL POINTS. I MENTION THIS PARTICULAR SUBSTITUTED BECAUSE THIS WAS DONE IN 2008. THIS IS NOT PARTICULARLY NEW. IT IS NEW TO ALL OF US NOW BECAUSE OF THE RECENT FIRE LOSSES THIS IS FRONT OF MIND. WHAT WAS PREVIOUSLY OFTEN SEEN MORE ICE SATED AND RURAL -- ISOLATED AND RURAL. SO WITH THIS SHOW IT IS IMPACT OF FIRE TRANSITIONING FROM VEGETATION TO STRUCTURE. THE LEFT TOP RIGHT SHOWS THE POINT OF TRANSITION. WHERE FIRE MOVED OFF THE LANDSCAPE AND

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TRANSITIONED INTO A NUMBER OF VULNERABLE HOMES. AS THOSE HOMES BEGIN TO BURN MOVING FROM TOP LEFT TO RIGHT AND LEFT TO RIGHT AGAIN, YOU SEE THE GROWTH OF THE FIRE AS IT SPREAD NOT BY VEGETATION BUT BY STRUCTURES. WHERE EACH STRUCTURE IS IGNITING ADJACENT STRUCTURES WITHIN 50 FEET. AS WE SEE QUICKLY WHAT BEGAN AS A SMALL VEGETATION FIRE TRANSITIONING TO A SMALL NUMBER OF HOMES CAN BE URBAN CON --

>> THE HOMES ARE HARDENED AT THE POINTS OF TRANSITION ALL OF THAT ENERGY IS EXPENDED NOT ABLE TO GAIN A FOOTHOLD.

>> THE CHALLENGE HERE IS THAT IN THE GRAPH ON THE LIGHT THE LINE REPRESENTS MITIGATIONS. AS YOU CARRY OUT MITIGATIONS THERE WILL BE A LINEAR INCREASE ON THE LANDS ESCAPE. YOU DON'T SEE RISK REDUCTION BENEFIT UNTIL A CRITICAL MASS OF THOSE HAVE BEEN ACHIEVED BOTH ON THE VIGIL PARCEL. A -- INDIVIDUAL PARCEL. A HOME THAT IS MITIGATED IS NOT MITIGATED. UNLIKE WATER IF YOU HAVE A SMALL HOLE IN YOUR ROOF AND IT'S RAINING YOU DON'T HAVE A FLOOD YOU HAVE A LEAK. YOUR ASSET IS YOUR NEIGHBOR'S PERIL. THERE WAS A CRITICAL BREAK OVER POINT WHERE ENOUGH MITIGATIONS HAVE BEEN CARRIED OUT AT 100% PER HOME AND ENOUGH WITHIN A GEOGRAPHIC AREA THAT WE SEE NETWORK EFFECTS. OR NNT. THE BARS ON THE GRAPH REPRESENT COMMUNITY RISK. AS THE LINE CLIMBED YOU HAVE TO GET TO THE CRITICAL MASS OF LITIGATIONS TO SEE THE BENEFIT. TO QUOTE/UNQUOTE IBHS SOMETHING IS NOT BETTER THAN NOTHING. YOU

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WOULD BE WEATHER OFF NOT TO -- BETTER OFF NOT TO UNDERTAKE A MITIGATION PROGRAM UNLESS THAT WAS TO INCLUDE ALL CRITICAL ELEMENTS INCLUDING ZONE ZERO WHICH IS IN SOME WAYS MOST DIFFICULT AND

>> ON THE LEFT A REPRESENTATION OF WHAT HAPPENS WHERE FIRE ENTERS THE COMMUNITY. WHERE MITIGATED PARCELS ARE SPREAD OUT. THOSE HOMES ARE RESISTIVE. FIRES WILL FIND THOSE PATHWAYS THAT RUN THROUGH THEM AND MAKE THE WAY TO THE BULK OF THE COMMUNITY. THE RIGHT WHERE WE CLUSTER THOSE TREATMENTS. WE ACHIEVE HEARD IMMUNITY THAT FIRE CANNOT MAKE THAT TRANSITION. THIS IS REALLY A DISCUSSION OF CONSTRAINED OPTIMIZATION. IF WE HAVE A FINITE AMOUNT OF RESOURCES. TIME, STAFF CAPACITY, MONEY, COMMUNITY WILL TO ACT WE ARE FAR BETTER OFF TO CLUSTER THOSE TREATMENTS TO THE POINT WHERE THEY'LL HAVE THE GREATEST BENEFIT AND ACHIEVE. THE SECOND IS THE RELATED DISCUSSION WHICH IS CERTAINLY FRONT OF MIND TO MANY RESIDENTS TO INCLUDE MYSELF ACCESS AND AVAILABILITY OF INSURANCE. TO VALUE THE PRESENCE OR ABSENCE.

>> THE VALUE OF THAT WORK CLIMBS UNTIL 85% HAVE CARRIED OUT THE MITIGATIONS AND IT CARRIES OFF.

THE LAST 15% ARE FREE RIDERS. THE STUDY ON THE RIGHT IN PARADISE. WE LOOKED AT THE AVERAGE ANNUAL LOSS BY ACTUARIES AND CAT MODELERS. WE LOOKED AT THE BASELINE FOR TOTAL INSURED. THE AREAS SHOWN IN RED THAT'S VERY BAD. IT WOULD BE VERY HARD TO GET

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INSURANCE IF YOU'RE IN AREAS TO -- THE RIGHT IS 43,000 ACRES OF BUFFERED TREATMENT AREAS RECOMMENDED AROUND THE COMMUNITY IN CONJUNCTION WITH HOME HARDENING. IN THE CASE OF PARADISE, THEY'RE ABLE TO APPLY THE MORE RESTRICTIVE CODES THAT HAVE BEEN IN PLACE SINCE 2008. NO WOODEN FENCES NO VEGETATION WITHIN FIVE FEET. THEY ARE REBUILDING OF WHAT IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE. WE RAN A MODELING EXERCISE IF THAT WAS IN THE COMMUNITY WAS 43,000 ACRES OF TREATMENTS AROUND THE COMMUNITY. THIS WAS A STUDY. THERE'S NO FUTURE IN WHICH PARADISE CARRIES 43,000 ACRES. IT WAS AN INTERESTING STUDY ABOUT WHAT WOULD HAPPEN IF WE BUFFERED THE COMMUNITY AND IT WAS PREPARED TO RECEIVE FIRE. THE RESULTS WERE ENCOURAGING. THE BUFFERS AND HOME HARDENING RESULTED IN 65% REDUCTION IN AAL. YOU CAN SEE AS A PERCENTAGE AND DOLLAR FIGURE THE ANNUAL LOSS CURVE WAS BENT SHARPLY. THE TAKEAWAY OF THE RISK REDUCTION OPPORTUNITIES THAT WERE AVAILABLE, ONLY 25% OF THOSE WERE ACHIEVED BY THE BUFFERS AROUND THE COMMUNITY. 75% OF THE POSSIBLE RISK REDUCTION LAY FROM CREATING DEFENSIBLE SPACE IN THE HOME HARDENING. ALL OF THAT WORK THAT WOULD BE EXPENSIVE AND REQUIRE A REOCCURRING MAINTENANCE. THE VAST MAJORITY OF THE BENEFITS WERE TO BE GAINED IN DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HOME HARDENING WITHIN THE COMMUNITY. SO I WOULD LIKE TO BRIEFLY TAKE YOU THROUGH OUR APPROACH TO THIS PROBLEM OVER THE LAST FEW YEARS. INCLUDING WHAT WE LEARNED ABOUT [INDISCERNIBLE] TO

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BETTER EXPLAIN WHAT'S NOT WORKING. I PROMISE THIS IS THE LAST FEW NUMBERS WE WILL THROW AT YOU. THIS SLIDE SUMMARIZES AN HOUR-LONG PRESENTATION THAT WE GAVE AND WHAT WE'RE CURRENTLY DOING -- WE SHARE THE MIC BUTTON THERE.

>> SINCE THE PASSAGE OF FF WE REMOVED -- AS OF THIS MORNING -- WE'RE IN THE PROCESS OF MODIFYING 110 ACRES THAT SERVE AS EVACUATION ROUTES IN 2025 WE WILL BEGIN LEVERAGING A MILLION DOLLAR GRANT. OUR INSPECTION PROGRAMS RESULTED IN 21,000 INDIVIDUAL INSPECTIONS. THE INSPECTION PROGRAM HAS BEEN EFFECTIVE IN EDUCATION AND INITIATING FUEL REDUCTION AND TRYING TO MOVE 9,000 HOMEOWNERS WILL TAKE TOO LONG. OUR INSPECTORS RARELY SEE ALL FOUR SIDES OF THE STRUCTURE. MOVING FORWARD THE NUMBER OF PARCELS WE INSPECT WILL GO DOWN AND MORE TIME PER INSPECTION. HIGHER QUALITY OF INSPECTIONS WITHIN THE COMMUNITY.

>> WHAT ARE WE PROPOSING TONIGHT. INITIATIVE CALLED EMBER. BEFORE I DIVE IN, I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE IT'S EASY TO FEEL OVERWHELMED THAT THIS IS AN INSURMOUNTABLE PROBLEM. TOO MUCH EFFORT, TOO MUCH EMOTIONAL CAPITAL AND MONEY TO ADDRESS THESE ISSUES. IT'S EASY TO FEEL THAT POWER LINES SHOULD BE UNDER GROUNDED COMPLETELY OR THE PARK DEPARTMENT SHOULD CLEAR CUT. I BELIEVE IT'S WORTH US MOVING FORWARD. WHAT WE ARE GOING TO PRESENT IS WHAT WE HAVE DIRECT CONTROL OVER. WE CAN GAIN A SUBSTANTIAL AMOUNT OF RISK REDUCTION BY DOING THIS WORK

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REGARDLESS OF WHAT HAPPENS OUTSIDE OF OUR BORDERS. WHILE THOSE EFFORTS SHOULD BE PURSUED THEY'RE OUT OF OUR DIRECT CONTROL. EVEN IF POWER LINES ARE UNDER GROUNDED AND VEGETATION IS COMPLETELY MANAGED IN THE PARK TO OUR SATISFACTION FIRES WILL STILL OCCUR. WE'RE IN A FIRE DEPENDENT LANDSCAPE FIRE EXISTED BEFORE POWER LINES, PARKS DISTRICT AND HUMANS. THERE'S THREE SIDES THAT SUMMARIZE ALL THE PROPOSALS. THE FIRST SERIES OF PROPOSALS HAS TO DO WITH THE AMENDMENTS OF THE FIRE CODE AND SPECIFICALLY CREATING A BUFFER ZONE WHICH WE'RE CALLING ZONE FOUR RIGHT NOW THAT ENCOMPASSES THE EASTERN QUARTER MILE OF THE CITY FROM PEAK TO CANYON. IT'S IN THIS BUFFER ZONE AND HILL BOTH AREAS HIGHLIGHTED IN RED THAT WE WANT TO TAKE MEANINGFUL STEPS AND FOCUS OUR WORK WE BELIEVE THAT WILL GIVE THE HIGHEST RETURN ON OUR INVESTMENT. WITHIN THE AREAS WE ARE PROPOSING TO ADOPT ZONE ZERO. THIS INCLUDES VEGETATION, WOODEN MULCH AND PERPENDICULAR FENCES.

>> WE OFTEN FOCUS ON WHAT THE COST IS OF A DISASTER. IN LA THE ESTIMATES ARE IN HUNDREDS OF BILLIONS OF DOLLARS. WE'RE PROPOSING ON WORKING ON RESEARCH AND THAT WILL FLIP THAT ON ITS HEAD. WHAT IS THE VALUE OF WHAT WE COULD POTENTIALLY SAVE BY DOING THESE LITIGATIONS? -- MITIGATIONS. IT'S A RELATIVELY SMALL INVESTMENT NOW CAN AVOID A MASSIVE COST IN THE FUTURE. THE SECOND PROPOSALS HAS TO DO WITH THE BUILD ENVIRONMENT. WE CAN

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REDUCE RISK OF WILD-FIRE SPREADING BY MANAGING VEGETATION AND REMOVING FLAMMABLE MATERIALS AROUND HOMES, EMBERS REMAIN A CHALLENGE. TO TRULY PROTECT A HOME IT MUST BE HARDENED. IT'S BUILT OR RETROFITTED WITH MATERIALS THAT CAN WITHSTAND THESE EXPOSURES. THROUGH GIS MODELING WE KNOW -- 2008 IS WHEN THE STATE ADOPTED A MORE RESTRICTIVE FIRE CODE THAT REQUIRED HARDENING OF STRUCTURES AGAINST WILDFIRE. WE HAVE THOUSANDS OF EXISTING HOMES THAT REQUIRE HARDENING. MANY OF THESE HOME HARDENING MODIFICATIONS ARE RELATIVELY INEXPENSIVE AND SIMPLE. INCLUDING DIY AND THEY BENEFIT US WITH A SIGNIFICANT REDUCTION IN RISK. THIS SET OF PROPOSAL WILL CHARGE THE PLANNING AND FIRE DEPARTMENT. WITH A SET OF PROPOSALS FOR THE COMMUNITY AND COUNCIL TO CONSIDER THAT WOULD IMPROVE THE EMBER RESISTANCE OF BERKELEY'S FIRE ZONES. WITH -- WE KNOW THAT SOME OF THESE MODIFICATIONS CAN BE EXPENSIVE. SO IN ADDITION TO THAT STAFF WORK ON THE CODE AMENDMENTS -- WE'LL COME BACK WITH PROPOSALS ON CREATING INCENTIVES AND OTHERWISE FUNDING TO HELP RESIDENTS IMPLEMENT THESE IMPORTANT MITIGATIONS. ONE EXAMPLE WHERE THEY PROVIDED UP A $7500 CREDIT PER HOUSE THAT WOULD GOING TO REPLACE THE ROOF. THEY HAVE REPLACED ALMOST ALL THE WOOD ROOFS.

>>

>> THIS TYPE OF FIRE WILL OVERTAKE THE PACE WITH WHICH RESIDENTS CAN EVACUATE THE HILLS. THE RESULT OF THIS IS PREDICTABLE. IN

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FACT, WE'VE SEEN IT PLAY OUT OVER AND OVER AGAIN ACROSS THE WEST. PEOPLE WILL BE INJURED AND KILLED AS ATTEMPTING TO EVACUATE AHEAD OF A FIRE THAT IS MOVING AT A FOOTBALL FIELD A SECOND. PART OF OUR RESPONSE SHOULD BE TO MOVE PEOPLE OUT OF THE FIRE ZONES ESPECIALLY THOSE VULNERABLE AND NEED TIME TO LEAVE. BEFORE AN IGNITION OCCURS. THE OTHER KEY COMPONENTS RECOMMENDED IN THIS CONNECTION ARE -- SECTION ARE FOR COUNCIL TO AFFIRM THE STAFFING RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DIRECTLY RESULT IN THE ABILITY TO BE PROPERLY STAFFED. MANY OF THESE STAFFING RECOMMENDATIONS THERE ARE SEVERAL UNFUNDED AND WE CAN CONSIDER THOSE WHEN THE BUDGET ALLOWS. WE KNOW OUR TRANSPORTATION INFRASTRUCTURE IN THE HILLS IS NOT ADEQUATE AND WE BELIEVE IT'S NECESSARY TO LOOK AT STEPPING UP EXISTING -- AND CONSIDERING NEW PARKING RESTRICTIONS THAT WOULD BE IMPLEMENTED DURING PERIODS OF EXTREME FIRE WEATHER. THIS BRINGS THE BEST PRACTICE OF SCIENCE SUPPORTED. WE FEEL WE CAN NO LONGER BE HELD BACK BY A CONCERN THAT THERE'S NOT ADEQUATE COMMUNITY SUPPORT OR APPETITE FOR THIS WORK. WE CANNOT LET LOS ANGELES BE JUST ANOTHER DISASTER. WITH HAVE AN -- WE HAVE AN OPPORTUNITY TO RELEARN FROM THEIR EXPERIENCE. NY THERE ARE TWO INTERLOCKING PIECES. AS WE GO THROUGH THIS I WOULD LIKE TO LEAD WITH A QUOTE FROM THE INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS AND HOME SAFETY. A NONPROFIT RESEARCH FIRM THAT HAS DONE MUCH OF THE EXPERIMENTATION. SOMETHING IS NOT BETTER THAN NOTHING. IGNITION

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ZONE ZERO AND HOME HARDENING NEED TO BE ADOPTED FULLY IF THEY'RE TO BE WORTH THE EFFORT AT ALL.

>> THIS EXPERIMENT SHOWS A HOME AFTER 10 MINUTES OF EXPOSURE. THE HALF ON THE LEFT IS MATERIAL PRIOR TO THE CODE. THE LEFT-HAND SIDE ALSO HAS COMBUSTIBLE MATERIAL WITHIN FIVE FEET. IN THIS CASE WOOD MULCH AND PLANTS. ON THE RIGHT IS A HOME BUILT TO THE NEW CODE OF FIVE FEET NONCOMBUSTIBLE SPACE. THESE TWO PIECES WORK TOGETHER. WITHOUT FIVE FEET OF SPACE BETWEEN A HOME AND ANYTHING THAT CAN BURN THE DIRECT FLAME EXPOSURE TO A BUILDING WILL OVERCOME THE RESISTANT MATERIALS. A SIMILAR EXPERIMENT ON CAL FIRE. ON THE RIGHT, NOTHING WITHIN FIVE FEET OF THE HOME. ONE ADDITION TO THIS EXPERIMENT IS THE WOODEN FENCE WITHIN FIVE FEET. ON THE LEFT YOU HAVE A WOODEN FENCE ALL THE WAY TO THE STRUCTURE. ON THE RIGHT WITH THE SECTION OF FENCE IS REPLACED WITH A NONCOMBUSTIBLE FENCE WITHIN FIVE FEET. THE LESSON HERE THAT WOODEN FENCE BECOMES AN EXTENSION OF THE HOME AND WICKING THAT FIRE LIKE A FUSE TOWARD THE STRUCTURE. THIS BECOMES THE NEXT ORIGIN POINT OF EMBERS TO CREATE ADDITIONAL LOSS. ONE OF THE UNIQUE FEATURES OF LOS ANGELES IS THE VOLUME OF VIDEO EVIDENT. ANALYSIS AND SURVEY WORK DONE AROUND THESE INITIATIVES. THIS CAMERA OPERATOR DOCUMENTING THE LOSS OF A STRUCTURE AND NOTICED A SPOT FIRE NEXT TO THE HOME BEHIND HIM. THIS SPOT FIRE WILL GROW ALITE LIGHTING THE WELL WATER PLANTS AROUND IT AND

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CONSUMING THE HOME. THIS IS HOW FIRES CONSUME NEIGHBORHOODS. ONE HOUSE AT A TIME THROUGH SPOT FIRES LIT BY EMBERS. THE OPERATOR PANS DOWN THE STREET AND NOTICED ANOTHER SPOT FIRE DOWN THE BLOCK.

>> ON THE THEIR WAY OUT THEY NOTICE AN ADDITIONAL HOME. A SPOT FIRE THAT STARTED WELL TO THE RIGHT AND DRAWN LEFT TO THE HOME BY WAY OF VEGETATION AN WOODEN FENCE ATTACHED TO THE HOME. WE INCLUDED THIS IMAGE -- FROM THE 2019 KINCAID FIRE TO DEMONSTRATION HOW LANDSCAPING CAN PREVENT. IT REDIRECTS HEAT AND EMBERS AWAY FROM THE HOME. HERE IS AN EXAMPLE OF A HOME IN BERKELEY WITHIN THE PROPOSED FIRE ZONE THAT HAS SIMILAR FEATURES. THERE'S AREAS OF IMPROVEMENT BUT A GREAT EXAMPLE OF A PROPERTY THAT HAS MUCH OF THE BEST PRACTICES. HERE ARE A COUPLE OF CLASSIC EXAMPLES FROM THE PROPOSED FIRE ZONE FOUR. THE HOME IS LIKELY PROVIDING PRIVACY FROM THE ROAD BELOW. BOTH OF THESE WOULD REQUIRE SIGNIFICANT WORK UNDER THE NEW CODE. AND BOTH OF THESE PHOTOS ALL OF THE VEGETATION WITHIN FIVE FEET OF THE HOME WOULD NEED TO BE REMOVED AND VEGETATION OUTSIDE OF FIVE FEET WOULD NEED TO BE BROUGHT TO COMPLIANCE.

>> ONCE IGNITED WITH WITHOUT FIREFIGHTER PREVENTION.

>>

>> THIS PROGRAM WILL BE AVAILABLE STARTING THIS SUMMER AND WOULD BE AVAILABLE TO RESIDENTS WHO QUALIFY FOR FINANCIAL AND MEDICAL

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REASONS. HOME HARDENING AGAINST EMBERS ESPECIALLY COUPLED WITH ZONE ZERO SHOWS TO INCREASE STRUCTURE SURVIVAL RATES AND NECESSARY TO ACHIEVE FULL PROTECTION. THERE ARE MANY INEXPENSIVE HOME HARDENING FEATURES INSTALLING GUTTER GUARDS, REPLACES GATES AND FENCES THAT CONNECT TO HOME WITHIN FIVE FEET WITH NON-COMBUSTIBLE MATERIAL. WE'RE RUNNING A PROGRAM PROVIDING GUTTER GUARDS AND SCREENS TO ALL PROPERTIES IN THE ZONE AND EXPANDING TO OTHER AREAS. WE NEED TO IDENTIFY AND SECURE FINANCIAL INCENTIVE OR SUPPORT PROGRAMS TO IMPLEMENT THIS CRITICAL PUZZLE PIECE IF IT'S TO BE IMPLEMENTED.

>> THIS IS FROM LOS ANGELES AND IT'S WHY HOMES BURN. THESE EMBERS ARE BLOWN FROM OTHER BURNING STRUCTURES AND VEGETATION.

>> ONCE A HOME IS IGNITED [INDISCERNIBLE] .

>> THIS IS WHAT WE SAW IN LOS ANGELES. AS A RESULT LEGACY APPROACHES WHICH WERE FOCUSED ON EXTERNAL FUEL BREAKS FALL SHORT OF OUR GOAL. WE FAIL TO RECOGNIZE THE MOST ABUNDANT AND DRIEST FUEL IN OUR HILLS THAT REQUIRES INTERVENTION IS IN FACT THE HOMES THEMSELVES. WE MUST HARD THE HOME AND GIVE IT THE SPACE FOR A FIGHTING CHANCE.

>> OUR CURRENT FIRE CODE AND INSPECTIONS FALL SHORT OF SCIENTIFIC MITIGATIONS.

>> THIS RESULTS IN THE FIRE DEPARTMENT TELLING RESIDENTS THEY'VE DONE WHAT THEY ARE REQUIRED. THIS OFTEN CONTRIBUTES TO INCREASED

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PREMIUMS AND NONRENEWALS. BERKELEY IS TO HAVE 5.3 BILLION OF SEATS. WHICH INDUSTRY'S INDICATIONS.

>> I LIKE TO BRING DIRECTOR TO TALK ABOUT A KEY PIECE OF EVACUATION STRATEGY THAT'S BEEN REINFORCED AGAIN THIS TIME IN LOS ANGELES.

>> GOOD EVENING. WE AS A DEPARTMENT UNDERSTAND THAT WE HAVE TO CHANGE OUR APPROACH TO WILDFIRE AND THIS INCLUDES OUR APPROACH TO EVACUATION. FOR MANY YEARS, THE INSTRUCTION HAS BEEN TO HAVE A GO BAG READY, WAIT FOR YOUR EVACUATION ORDER AND PACK UP AND LEAVE. BUT WE'VE SEEN IN FIRES THROUGHOUT CALIFORNIA THAT THAT APPROACH DOES NOT WORK FOR URBAN AREAS. AND AS WE ALL KNOW BERKELEY'S HILLS ARE FULL OF NARROW WINDING ROADS THAT WE CALL SPAGHETTI STREETS THAT ALSO HAVE 30,000 PEOPLE IN THEM. THESE ROADWAYS WILL NOT SUPPORT A QUICK EVACUATION. OUR EVACUATION CHALLENGE IS NOT NEW. IT IS NOT UNIQUE. THIS SLIDE SHOWS TWO PICTURES THAT LOOK ALMOST I DENT CALL. THE TOP PICTURE FROM LAST MONTH IN THE PALISADES FIRE IN LOS ANGELES, CARS ARE BACKED UP IN TRAFFIC AND PEOPLE ARE ABANDONING THEM. YOU CAN MAKE IT OUT IN THE BACK CAR. THERE'S SOMEBODY PULLING OUT A WALKER FOR SOMEONE TO USE TO EVACUATE ON FOOT. THE BOTTOM PICTURE IS OURS. FROM THE 1991 OAKLAND-BERKELEY HILLS FIRE. CARS BACKED UP PEOPLE RUNNING OUT. YOU CAN MAKE IT OUT THE WOMAN IN THE WHITE SHIRT IS NOT WEARING SHOES. IN BOTH OF THESE PICTURES THE ONLY THING THAT

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IS MOVING FAST IS THE FIRE. WE KNOW THAT OUR ROADWAYS AND HILLS WILL NOT SUPPORT LARGE GROUPS OF PEOPLE TRYING TO MOVE OUT AT THE SAME TIME. THIS IS NOT ACCEPTABLE. NOT MUCH HAS CHANGED ABOUT OUR ROADWAY NETWORK SINCE 1991 OTHER THAN WE HAVE MORE PEOPLE WHO WILL NEED TO USE THESE STREETS TO EVACUATE. WE HAVE FOUND AN OPPORTUNITY HERE. WE CANNOT TELL YOU WHERE AND WHEN A FIRE WILL START. WE CAN TELL YOU WHEN BERKELEY WILL HAVE THE WEATHER ASSOCIATED WITH SO MANY OF THESE. AS THE CHIEF TALKED ABOUT WINDS PUSH A FIRE AND EMBERS AND LOW HUMIDITY HELPS THINGS IGNITE WHEN THOSE EMBERS LAND. THIS CHART CHOSE WIND, GETTING STRONGER TO THE RIGHT AND HUMIDITY GETTING LOWER AS YOU MOVE DOWN. WE DON'T HAVE EVERY FIRE ON THIS CHART, BUT IF WE DID IT WOULD NEARLY ALL BE IN THAT BOTTOM RIGHT CORNER. THAT INCLUDES THE OAKLAND-BERKELEY HILLS FIRE. THE CAMPFIRE IN PARADISE. THE FIRES IN MAUI AND THE FIRES IN LOS ANGELES. THEY ALL SPREAD IN THESE CONDITIONS. THESE CONDITIONS ARE PREDICTABLE. AND WHEN THE FORECAST DIRECTS THEM IN BERKELEY -- PREDICTS THEM IN BERKELEY WE CALL IT EXTREME FIRE WEATHER. DURING EXTREME FIRE WEATHER WE ADVISE PEOPLE WHO LIVE IN THE HILLS LEAVE EARLY BEFORE A FIRE STARTS WAS A OF THOSE -- BECAUSE OF THOSE PICTURES I SHOWED YOU. WE INTRODUCED THE FIRE

>> WE'VE ONLY HAD TO PROCLAIM EXTREME FIRE WEATHER TWICE SINCE THAT TIME. ONCE IN 2020 AND LAST FALL IN 2024. SO RIGHT NOW OUR

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OFFICE IS WORKING WITH THE SERVICE -- WEATHER SERVICE TO LOOK AT BERKELEY'S FIRE WEATHER AS WELL AS LOOKING AT THE RECENT SO THAT WE CAN IDENTIFY AND ADOPT THE MOST CONSERVATIVE TRIGGERS THAT STILL CAPTURE THOSE WEATHER CONDITIONS THAT WERE IGNITING THESE MAJOR WILDFIRES IN THE PAST 10 YEARS. YOU REALLY WANT TO USE THIS TO REDUCE THE NUMBER OF ADVISORIES THAT WE HAVE TO ISSUE. CHIEF?

>> THANKS.

>> SO THIS SOUNDS LIKE A LOT OF WORK AND IT IS. I WOULD LIKE TO SPEND A COUPLE MINUTES TALKING ABOUT IF WE DO THIS AS A COMMUNITY IT'S NOT ONLY POSSIBLE BUT MUCH MORE EFFECTIVE. LET'S CIRCLE BACK TO THE IMAGES. THE PROPOSED FIRE ZONE FOUR. THE TOP SHOWING THE RISK OF MULTIPLE HOMES IGNITING IF ONE IS BURNING. THE LOWER SHOWS HOW THE FIRE GETS SPREAD. TOGETHER SHOWING WHY WE NEED TO FOCUS OUR RESOURCES RIGHT THERE.

>> THIS IS THE QUOTE/UNQUOTE MIRACLE HOUSE. IT'S OVER 100 YEARS OLD. BUILT LONG BEFORE THE BUILDING CODE. ITS SURVIVAL HAS BEEN CREDIT FROM LUCKY TO DIVINE. ON THE LEFT IS A CHART FROM A POST INCIDENT ANALYSIS OF THE CAMPFIRE. THE CHART IS SHOWING WHY A HOME BURNT. THE THREE FACTORS THAT STAND OUT ARE DEFENSIBLE SPACE, COMBUSTIBLE ROOF AND VENTS THAT ALLOW EMBERS. THE OWNERS OF THIS HOME HAD BOUGHT IT TWO YEARS BEFORE THE FIRE AND IT NEEDED SUBSTANTIAL WORK. THE FIRST TWO THINGS THAT THEY DID WERE

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REPLACE THE ROOF WITH A METAL ONE AND REMOVE THE VEGETATION REPLACING IT WITH STONE AND OTHER NONCOMBUSTIBLE MATERIALS. THIS PASSIVELY CONTRIBUTED TO THE FIRE FIGHT. THE HOMEOWNERS' EFFORTS WERE AND NOT A LIABILITY. IF YOU WERE A FIRE FIGHTER IS THIS A HOUSE YOU CAN PROTECT. WOULD YOUR EFFORTS BE BOLSTERED? WOULD THE AREA AROUND LEND ITSELF TO THE FIGHT OR MAKE THE FIGHT HARDER. SURROUNDED BY FIRE CAN YOU PROVIDE PROTECTION FROM THE HOME IN FRONT OF YOU BUT THOSE BEHIND IT. LOOKING FOR ACTIONS THAT WILL CREATE A STOP FOR THE ENTIRE NEIGHBORHOOD. IT'S TOO BAD THAT EVERYTHING WEST OF THE HOUSE WAS THE OCEAN.

>> WHAT IS FAR MORE INTERESTING IS WHAT HAPPENED ONE MILE NORTH OF THAT HOUSE. IT'S CLEARLY A PATH OF FAIR MOVING -- FIRE MOVING THROUGH THE COMMUNITY LIKE WATER. THE YELL LOW CIRCLE IS -- THE COMMUNITY -- INSTRUCTED IN 2017. ONLY FIVE STRUCTURES IN THE COMMUNITY WERE DESTROYED. JUST AS IMPORTANT IS THE ROLE THE NEIGHBORHOOD PLAYED IN SLOWING THE FIRE TO THE COMMUNITIES IN THE NORTH. IN ORDER TO REACH THE NORTHERN PART THE FIRE HAD TO FIND AN ALTERNATE PATHWAY BEGGING THE QUESTION. WHAT WOULD THE OUTCOME HAVE BEEN IF THERE WAS A STRETCH OF RESILIENT HOMES? THIS IS NOT A ONE-TIME SUCCESS STORY. A FIRE RAN UP THE CANYON TOWARD THIS COMMUNITY. THEY DO NOT HAVE THE FIRE FIGHTER RESPONSE OF CALIFORNIA. THERE WAS NO ONE TO DEFEND THIS COMMUNITY. THIS COMMUNITY KNEW THE RISKS AND BUILT WITH THE

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STANDARDS THAT ARE MISSING FROM OLDER HOUSING STOCK. BECAUSE THE STRUCTURES ARE CLOSER TOGETHER THE COMMUNITY CREATED A DEFENSE BUFFER. THIS COMMUNITY FOUGHT THIS FIRE AND WON YEARS BEFORE THE FIRE EVER GOT THERE.

>> SO, ENDING THIS THIS EVENING'S PRESENTATION WITH A REVIEW OF -- ON THE SCREEN, OF THE EMBER INITIATIVES AND A REMINDER THAT THE PROPOSALS OUTLINED TODAY REPRESENT THE MOST EFFECTIVE STEPS WE KNOW OF TO TAKE STEPS. IMPLEMENTING DEFENSIBLE SPACE MEASURES ZONE ZERO AND HOME HARDENING WILL REQUIRE CHANGE THAT COSTS MONEY AND ALTAR FAMILIAR LANDSCAPES. CHANGE IS HARD. CHANGE IS OCCURRING WITHOUT OUR PERMISSION. AND THE REALITY IS DOING NOTHING IS AN OPTION THAT HAS PREDICTABLE OUTCOMES. HISTORY SHOWN THROUGH THE DEVASTATING FIRES THAT OUR REGION IS HIGHLY VULNERABLE TO FAST MOVING. WILDFIRE IS NOT A DISTANT THREAT. IT'S A CERTAINTY. OUR RESPONSE PROACTIVE. THIS APPROACH IS ROOTED IN SCIENCE AND ALIGNING WITH THE CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE. ALL MAJOR INSURES WHO HAVE MODEL THIS IN THEIR RISK.

>> GOVERNOR'S -- OF A ZONE ZERO LAW OF ALL HIGH HAZARD ZONES ALL OF BERKELEY HILLS BY MARCH OF 2025 WITH FINAL ADOPTION AT THE END OF THE YEAR. I DON'T THINK I COULD SAY THIS BETTER THE GOVERNOR'S QUOTE WAS WE ARE LIVING IN A NEW REALITY OF EXTREMES. LEAVE THE -- BELIEVE THE SCIENCE. MOTHER NATURE IS CHANGING THE

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WAY WE LIVE AND WE MUST CONTINUE ADAPTING. WE CAN TAKE THE STEPS TONIGHT TO DISCUSS MOVING FORWARD IN A CONTROLLED AND STRATEGIC WAY OR WAIT FOR THE WILDFIRE TO FORCE THE CHANGES UPON US. THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME AND LOOKING FORWARD TO QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION WITH THE COMMUNITY.

>> THANK YOU FOR THE PRESENTATION. WE'RE GOING TO TAKE PUBLIC COMMENT. I WOULD LIKE TO START WITH VICE MARE -- FORMER VICE MAYOR IF YOU COULD GIVE YOU COMMENT. IF THERE ARE OTHER FOLKS WHO HAVE PUBLIC COMMENT YOU CAN MOVE THIS DIRECTION AS WELL.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON EVERYBODY. IT'S NICE TO SEE YOU FROM THIS SIDE OF THE DAIS. AS THE FORMER COUNCIL PERSON REPRESENTING THE HIGH FIRE AREA OF THE CITY, AND AS A FOUNDING MEMBER OF THE EAST BAY WILDFIRE COALITION AND AS A 50-YEAR RESIDENT. I'M HERE TO SPEAK IN SUPPORT OF THE PACKAGE. I JUST WANT TO SAY IT'S VERY GRATIFYING TO ME TO SEE MY COLLEAGUES LISTENING TO ALL OF THIS AND TAKING IT ALL SERIOUSLY. AS YOU KNOW I SPENT MANY YEARS WORKING TO SORT OF BRING THIS KIND OF THING TO FRUITION. AND I REALLY APPRECIATE YOUR INTEREST AND HOPEFULLY YOUR SUPPORT. WE ALL KNOW THAT EXTREME WEATHER EVENTS BECOMING MORE FREQUENT CREATING CONDITIONS CONDUCIVE TO WILDFIRE.

>> I WANT TO -- CAN SOMEONE GIVE HER A MINUTE IF SHE WANTS ADDITIONAL TIME.

>> YOU'VE GOT A MINUTE.

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>> I'LL HURRY UP. THIS IS ALL OCCURRING VERY RAPIDLY IN OUR JOB IS TO ADAPT QUICKLY. AS BEST WE CAN. BY IMPLEMENTING SCIENTIFICALLY PROVEN BEST PRACTICES NOW TO PROTECT THE LIVES OF OUR RESIDENTS AND PROPS TO MAKE OUR CITY MORE RESILIENT. THE CLIMATE CONDITIONS LIKE DROUGHT AND LOW HUMIDITY HIGH VELOCITY WINDS ARE OUT OF OUR CONTROL. BY FOCUSING ON OUR EFFORTS AND RESOURCES ON THINGS THAT WE CAN CONTROL, LIKE REQUIRING DEFENSIBLE SPACE AND HARDENING AGAINST EMBER IGNITION, WE'RE TAKING STEPS THAT WILL PROVIDE US WITH THE CHANCE IN THE FACE OF THE NEW REALITY. KNOWING WHAT WE KNOW, YOU AS LEADERS, MUST TAKE ACTION TO TRY TO MITIGATE THE POTENTIAL DESTRUCTION. IS THIS PROPOSAL PERFECT? NO. IS THERE MORE TO DO? ABSOLUTELY. BUT LET'S NOT MAKE A THE PERFECT BE THE ENEMY OF THE GOOD. LET'S MOVE FORWARD THIS AFTERNOON AND TAKE THIS FIRST OF MANY STEPS TOWARDS KEEPING OUR CITY SAFER FROM WILDFIRE. ONE MORE POINT. INDIVIDUALISM IS DEEPLY ROOTED IN THE PSYCH KEY OF AMERICANS. AND BERKELEY IS NO EXCEPTION. THIS INITIATIVE WILL ONLY BE EFFECTIVE IF IT IS ADOPTED AND IMPLEMENTED ON A COMMUNITY-WIDE BASIS. AND THAT'S WHY YOU ALL, EVERYONE, MUST DO THEIR PART. WE WILL NEED YOUR LEADERSHIP AND HELP TO MAKE THIS HAPPEN. OUR TEAM OVER HERE, ARE ON THE CUTTING EDGE OF BEST PRACTICES FOR COMBATTING CATASTROPHIC WILDFIRE. THEY ARE APPLYING SCIENCE, ANALYZING FIRE BEHAVIOR AND UTILIZING TECHNOLOGY. I'VE WATCHED

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CLOSE UP FOR SEVERAL YEARS. YOU'RE NOT GOING TO FIND ANYBODY BETTER. THEY ARE COMMITTED AND PASSIONATE AND THEY KNOW WHAT THEY'RE TALKING ABOUT. LET'S GIVE THEM THE SUPPORT THEY NEED TO MAKE OUR CITY SAFER. THANK YOU.

>> A. ISHI: THANK YOU.

>> I DIDN'T GET TO SET EXPECTATIONS BEFOREHAND. BAUDS WE HAVE SO MANY -- BECAUSE WE HAVE SO MANY SPEAKERS YOU HAVE ONE MINUTE TO SPEAK. IF YOU HAVE -- WE HAVE MANY SPEAKERS TO GET THROUGH WE HAVE A WHOLE OTHER COUNCIL MEETING AFTER THIS. I WANT TO BE SENSITIVE TO FOLKS TIME.

>> HI. I CURRENTLY SERVE AS VICE CHAIR AS THE DISASTER FIRE AND SAFETY COMMISSION. I'M HERE AS A RESIDENT OF BERKELEY SPEAKING ONLY ON MY BEHALF. NY HOME IS BUILT ON THE ASHES OF THE 1923 FIRE. BUILT TO BE SOMEWHAT FIRE RESISTANT. STUCCO WALLS. FIRE SCIENCE HAS CHANGED, TECHNOLOGY HAS CHANGED AND OUR KNOWLEDGE OF BUILDING PRACTICES HAS CHANGED. I'VE SPENT QUITE A BIT OF TIME AND EFFORT TO FURTHER HARDEN THE HOME BY INSTALLING SCREENS ON GUTTERS, FENCE, AND LOOKING AT IMPLEMENTING A FEW ZONES ZERO RESPONSE. EVEN THOUGH I'M NOT IN THE PROPOSED ZONE FOUR. I'M HERE TO STRONGLY RECOMMEND THAT ALL OF US DO WHAT WE CAN TO POINT THIS INITIATIVE AND THE RESIDENTS KNOW IF THEY DON'T DO IT NOW THEY'RE GOING TO DO IT AND IT'S GOING TO BE A LOT MORE PAINFUL. THANK YOU.

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>> A. ISHI: THANK YOU.

>> HELLO. SORRY I DIDN'T KNOW ABOUT THE ONE MINUTE. MY NAME IS TODD I REPRESENT DISTRICT THREE SPEAKING ON MY OWN BEHALF. I SUPPORT CHIEF'S CALL FOR ZONE ZERO REGULATIONS. I WOULD ALSO RECOMMEND THAT THE ENTIRE CITY TAKE A HARD LOOK AT THESE REGULATIONS BECAUSE BERKELEY IS MORE SIMILAR TO LOS ANGELES THAN DISSIMILAR. WE ARE BOTH BELOW MOUNTAIN RANGE. WE HAVE THE HIGH-TENSION POWER LINES FROM UTILITY COMPANIES CROSSING THE RIDGE IN THE CITY. HERE IN OUR LOCAL CONTEXT THE FIRES IN LOS ANGELES WERE SPREAD BY 100 MILES PER HOUR WINDS. THOSE EMBERS IN LOS ANGELES WERE BLOWN TWO MILES. HERE THAT'S THE DISTANCE BETWEEN THE GRIZZLY PEAK FIRE STATION AND [INDISCERNIBLE] ONCE IT GOES ON --

>> DO YOU WANT TO FINISH YOUR SENTENCE?

>> COULD I? WHAT WE LEARNED IS ESSENTIALLY THIS. CLIMATE CHANGE HAS OUT RUN OUR EXISTING HUMAN SYSTEMS AND WE NEED TO RECALL GRATE OURSELVES AND -- RECALIBRATE OURSELVES. THANK YOU.

>> SHE'S GOING TO GIVE ME HER MINUTE. I'M HENRY PRESIDENT OF THE BERKELEY FIRE SAFE COUNCIL AND MEMBER OF THE EAST BAY ALLIANCE OF FIRE SAFE COUNCIL. WE WHOLEHEARTEDLY SUPPORT THE PROPOSED PROGRAM. WE JUST SUBMITTED LONGER TERM THAT GO FURTHER -- RECOMMENDATIONS THAT GO FURTHER. INCLUDING A ZONE ZERO REQUIREMENT FOR ALL THE HIGH SEVERITY ZONES. THE SYSTEMIC

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REMOVAL OF ALL EUCALYPTUS AND OTHER HAZARDOUS TREES. THE RESTORATION OF NEEDED AREAS WITH FIRE RESISTANCE NATIVE SHRUBS, TREES, AND GRASSES WHICH WE HAVE VOLUNTEERED TO FUND AND. THE WHOLE -- IMPLEMENT. A SIGNIFICANT PROPERTY TAX CREDIT THAT WILL DRIVE WIDE SCALE ADOPTION. THIS WILL HAVE TO BE FUNDED BY A BOND MEASURE OR OUTSIDE SOURCES. WE ESTIMATE CURRENTLY 25 TO 50 MILLION TO HARDEN THE 80% OF HOMES IN THE HIGH SEVERITY AREA. IN THE STRATEGIC PLAN AND EXPENDITURES FOR EACH OF THE MAJOR CATEGORIES. WE ALSO MADE THE LEAD -- RECOMMENDATIONS TO THE LEADERS OF UC BERKELEY, LAB, AND EAST BAY PARK DISTRICT TO CLEAN UP THE UNDER STORY OF THEIR EUCALYPTUS UNDER GROWTH. THIS IS RECOMMENDED BY THE -- THE FORMER GENERAL MANAGER OF THE EAST BAY PARK DISTRICT AND ALL THE COUNCILS IN THE EAST BAY. ONLY BERKELEY LAB IS CURRENTLY DOING THIS. IN A MEETING WITH MAYOR LAST FRIDAY. SHE HAD AN IDEA OF PARTNERS WITH THE CITY AND FIRE SAFE COUNCIL TO DO THE DEFENSIBLE SPACE WORK FOR LOW IN -- INCOME AND ELDERLY -- USING -- USING BOTH PUBLIC AND PRIVATE FUNDING AND DRAWING ON OUR MODEL OF 50 STUDENT SERVICE ORGANIZATIONS TO DO SOME OF THE WORK. I'M HERE TO SAY TO THE MARE -- MAYOR WE ACCEPT.

>> I APPRECIATE YOU ALL. I'M A STICKLER FOR TIME. THANK YOU.

>> MY NAME IS MICHAEL DOWNS. I LIVE RIGHT IN THE CENTER OF THE BUFFER ZONE. THESE ARE MY PERSONAL OBSERVATIONS. I DID NOT HEAR

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ABOUT ANY ALTERNATE SOLUTIONS. I WONDER IF THERE COULD BE SOME CONSIDERATION FOR A 200-FOOT WIDE FIRE BREAK EXTENDING EAST OF WILDCAT CANYON ROAD OR MORE SOLUTIONS IN LANGUAGE THAT DON'T RESULT IN INCREASED FIRE HAZARD RATINGS AND INSURANCE DENIALS. SECOND T COST BURDEN IS PUT ON THE HOMEOWNERS AND THAT THE PROPOSAL SHIFTS RESPONSIBILITIES AND LIABILITIES TO HOMEOWNERS WITHOUT COST APPROPRIATE INCENTIVES. INSURANCE RISK. I WONDER WHAT INSURANCE EXPERTS WOULD SAY ABOUT HOW THE NEW ZONE FOUR RATING MIGHT AFFECT FIRE INSURANCE POLICIES. PROPERTY VALUES, I IMAGINE REDUCE INSURE --

>> JUST AFFECTING THE REVENUE THAT THE CITY AND THE COUNTY RECEIVES.

>> HELLO. MY NAME IS DAN. I LIVE IN ANOTHER FIRE ZONE. AND I'M CONCERNED. EVERYONE'S REACTING TO THE LA FIRE. THERE WERE A NUMBER OF OTHER THINGS ABOUT THE LA FIRE. THERE WAS NO WATER IN THE HOSES BECAUSE THERE WAS INADEQUATE WATER. THERE WERE NO PROACTIVE BURNING OF BRUSH THAT NEAR THE CITY OR KEEPING THAT ALL CUT. A HUGE AMOUNT OF COMMITMENT WAS SITTING IN THE YARD THAT WAS NOT SERVICEABLE. SO RESPONSE TO COMPARE THAT TO HERE WHERE I BELIEVE WE'VE LEARNED A LOT OF LESSONS FROM THE 1991 FIRE WHERE PGE SHUTS OFF AUTOMATICALLY WHERE SPARKS DON'T HIT. THAT WE HAVE DRONES TO ENSURE THERE ARE NO BRANCHES OVER POWER LINES. I'M CONCERNED -- I HAVE A HISTORIC HOME AND THEY'VE TOLD

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ME THEY WANT ME TO REMOVE MY WINDOWS, DOOR, A BUNCH OF OTHER THINGS TO MAKE IT FIRE SAFE TO TODAY'S STANDARDS.

>> CAN I GET EVERYONE TO SILENCE THEIR CELL PHONES? THANK YOU.

>> A COUPLE QUICK POINTS ON ZONE ZERO. MY THOUGHT IS TO ENCOURAGE A LITTLE BIT OF FLEXIBILITY. IT TAKES A WHILE FOR PEOPLE TO TAKE A BIG JUMP. I DID NOTE THAT [INDISCERNIBLE] EXPERT PANEL SUGGESTED THAT AT ONE POINT, SOME OCCASIONAL PLANTS, LESS THAN 16 INCHES WITHIN THE FIVE FOOT AREA SURROUNDED BY ROCKS WOULD BE SOMETHING THAT WOULD ENCOURAGE PEOPLE TO MOVE TOWARDS IT. IN ADDITION THEY THOUGHT THAT HAVING POTS WITH PLANTS IN THEM WOULD WORK. I SEE MY TIME IS RUNNING OUT. LY SAY THAT ALSO, I THINK WE NEED SOME HELP FROM SACRAMENTO TO PROVIDE SOME OF THE FUNDING. A LOT OF THIS IS GOING TO VEGETATION WORK THAT CHIEF -- THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> THIS IS IMPORTANT. WE HAVE TO DO IT TOGETHER. AND WE HAVE A TEAM OF EXPERTS HERE WHO HAVE BEEN LOOKING AT THIS AND ARE MAKING A RECOMMENDATION AND I DON'T KNOW ABOUT YOU BUT I'M COMPELLED BY IT. IT LOOKS LIKE A GOOD IDEA. WE'VE BEEN HARDENING OUR HOUSE. WE HAVE A ZONE ZERO MOSTLY. GOT A COUPLE PLANTS THAT HAVE TO GO. IT'S NOT AN EASY PROCESS. IT'S GOING TO COST MONEY. BUT WE KIND OF HAVE THIS COLLECTIVE CHOICE HERE ABOUT WHETHER OR NOT WE'RE GOING TO DO SOMETHING AND IF WE'RE NOT GOING TO DO

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SOMETHING WE'RE TAKING AN ENORMOUS RISK. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> HELLO. I HAVE A WRITTEN STATEMENT. MY NAME IS CHERYL I'M A LOCAL ARCHITECT AND RESIDENT OF BERKELEY AND -- I ASSIST MANY PROPERTIES AS A HOME HARDENING SPECIALIST. MANY OF THE ACTIONS WE TAKE TO PROTECT OUR HOMES OR THE REGULAR MAINTENANCE THAT KEEP OUR PROPERTY AND INVESTMENT IN SOUND CONDITION. IT'S OUR RESPONSIBILITY TO DO THE WORK AND SOME PEOPLE WILL NEED HELP. ZONE ZERO IS A COMPONENT OF DEFENSIBLE SPACE. I COMMEND THE CITY FOR STEPPING UP. CITIZENS ARE LISTENING AFTER THE FIRES. THERE'S EVIDENCE AT THE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT IS COMMITTED TO SUPPORTING. WE KNOW THAT WILDFIRES ARE INEVITABLE. IT'S A WELL DOCUMENTED WE CAN EXPECT TO EXPERIENCE A MAJOR WILDFIRE -- I JUST NEED 30 SECONDS. WE CAN EXPECT TO EXPERIENCE A MAJOR WILDFIRE IN OUR HIGH-RISK AREAS AT LEAST ONCE IN THE TIME WE OWN A HOME. MEMORIES MAY BE ON THE SHORT SIDE BUT WILDFIRE WILL AFFECT OUR DENSELY -- WE HAVE LET MANY OF THE FUELS GET OUT OF CONTROL ON OUR PROPERTIES. IF WE ARE TO LIVE WITH FIRE WE MUST TAKE ACTION.

>> THANK YOU.

>> HI. I'M RUTH ERIN. I LIVE A BLOCK BELOW GRIZZLY PEAK. OUR NEIGHBORHOOD WAS CERTIFIED AS A FIRE WISE GROUP. THERE ARE NOW 13 NATIONALLY CERTIFIED FIRE WISE GROUPS IN BERKELEY. AND MANY

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OF THEM ARE ALONG THE RIDGE LINE IN ZONE FOUR. OR NEAR ZONE FOUR. AND WE NEED REGULATION AND ENFORCEMENT TO HELP US PROTECT OUR HOMES AND NEIGHBORHOODS. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> HI. MY NAME IS FERN. I'M FINISHING UP AN ECOLOGY PHD AND LIVE ON SUMMIT ROAD. I'M EXCITED TO SEE SUCH A SMART SCIENCE-INFORMED PLAN. IT'S UNREALISTIC TO TRY TO REMOVE ALL VEGETATION AND WITH THE LANDSLIDE RISK IN THE HILLS THAT'S ALSO SOMETHING TO CONSIDER. I COMMEND YOU AND I HOPE FOLKS WHO CAME UP WITH THE PLAN WILL COMMUNICATE WITH UC BERKELEY BECAUSE – THEY'RE NOT AS SCIENCE DRIVEN. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> I YIELD MY TIME TO ISABELLE GASTON.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. COUNCIL. MY NAME IS ISABELLE AND I LIVE ON WILDCAT CANYON WITH STEVE MY HUSBAND. I WOULD LIKE TO READ TO YOU AN E-MAIL I SENT TO MY LOCAL FIRE WISE GROUP TODAY BERKELEY WOODS. DID YOU GET THE COVID VACCINE? WHEN IT WAS FIRST AVAILABLE? WE FOLLOWED ADVICE. HIS SCIENTIFIC AND PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT. I ASK YOU TO DO THE SAME. FOLLOW THE SCIENCE. IN THIS CASE, FIRE SIGNS. THE EMBER PROPOSAL. NEED TO SUPPORT WE NEED. TO SUPPORT OUR FIRE CHIEFS SOUND JUDGMENT JUST LIKE WE FOLLOWED DOCTOR FAUCI. WE HAVE A MORAL IMPERATIVE TO FOLLOW THE MITIGATION MEASURES. WE DIDN'T CHOOSE TO LIVE IN A HIGH-FIRE

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HAZARD ZONE. BUT THIS IS WHAT CLIMATE CHANGE HAS BROUGHT TO ALL OF US. THERE IS GOOD NEWS. THERE'S SUFFICIENT EVIDENCE TO IMPLEMENT MEASURES THAT WOULD MITIGATE THE CAUSE OF UP TO 90% OF STRUCTURAL IGNITIONS AND THAT WAS IN THE CHIEF'S REPORT. SO WE CAN DO THIS BY FOLLOWING THE SCIENCE AND CREATING ZONE ZEROS. IT WILL NOT ONLY PROTECT OUR HOMES BUT OUR NEIGHBORS AND THEREFORE THE CITY WE LOVE. WE BELIEVE OUR HOME ON WILDCAT COULD VERY WELL BE THE FIRST LINE OF DEFENSE FOR OUR BRAVE FIRE FIGHTERS BECAUSE OUR ZONE ZERO AND HOME HANDWRITING WORK -- HOME HARDENING WORK. WE STILL HAVE MORE TO DO. THAT'S ANOTHER STORY. BUT THAT WORK IS MOOT UNLESS THE ENTIRE NEIGHBORHOOD DOES THE SAME. THE INSURANCE COMPANIES SEE IT THAT WAY, TOO.

>> CAN I HAVE ANOTHER 30 SECONDS FROM SOMEONE?

>> THANK YOU. WE CAN SLOW AND STOP A WILDFIRE IF WE TAKE THE SCIENTIFICALLY PROVEN MITIGATION STEPS. JUST LIKE WE STOPPED COVID IN ITS TRACKS WITH THE COVID VACCINES. FINALLY WE LOVE OUR GARDENS. WE LOVE OUR PLANTS. THIS IS AN EMOTIONAL ISSUE. FOR ALL OF US. WE CRIED WHEN THEY REMOVED THE LAST CAMILLE. WE NOW HAVE THEM IN LARGE POTS FIVE FEET AWAY. IT'S THE NEWS A. THANK YOU -- -- --

>> I LIVE ON WOODMONT AND I HAVE SUBMITTED COMMENTS TO YOU ALL ALREADY. I JUST WANTED TO COME AND SAY PUBLICLY I REALLY, REALLY APPRECIATE THE PROPOSAL THAT YOU HAVE PUT FORTH. THE SCIENCE

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BEHIND IT, THE INTELLIGENCE, THE CARE THAT WENT INTO THAT RECOMMENDATION. SO I JUST WANT TO URGE THE COUNCIL TO SUPPORT THIS PROPOSAL AND I'M GOING TO BE SUBJECT TO IT. I AM ABSOLUTELY HAPPY TO BE SUBJECT TO IT. BECAUSE IT WILL SAVE MY NEIGHBORHOOD, IT WILL SAVE -- I DON'T WANT TO BE THE ONLY HOME THAT SURVIVES IN THE NEIGHBORHOOD EITHER. I'M DOING EVERYTHING I CAN TO HARDEN MY HOME. BUT WE HEARD THE PRESENTATION. IT'S NOT ENOUGH FOR MY HOME TO DO WHAT IS NEEDED. WE NEED THE WHOLE NEIGHBORHOOD TO BE DOING IT. FOR THAT REASON, PLEASE, PLEASE SUPPORT THIS PROPOSAL. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> I THINK THERE WAS SOMEONE ELSE AHEAD OF YOU.

>> GO AHEAD.

>> MY NAME IS RALPH WALKER. WE'RE GOING TO HAVE A PROBLEM. UC BERKELEY IS NOT HAVING -- THEY'RE TRYING TO --

>> THIS IS THEY USUALLY GIVE IT AWAY FOR FREE. I'M TRYING TO LOOK IT UP WITH BERKELEY HIGH SCHOOL TO VISIT THERE. I NEED Y'ALL'S SUPPORT.

>> IS JES SI I UP HERE.

>> A. ISHI: I'M THE NEW MAYOR AN WE'RE TAKING COMMENTS ON A SPECIAL MEETING. COULD I ASK -- MAYBE MY STAFF CAN CHAT WITH YOU TO SPEAK WITH YOU ABOUT YOUR PARTICULAR ISSUE.

>> Y'ALL KNOW ABOUT SMITH OLYMPICS. [INDISCERNIBLE] ALL OF A

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SUDDEN I DIDN'T WANT TO OVER CHARGE HIM. I'M TRYING TO LOOK IT UP WITH BERKELEY HIGH SCHOOL. I NEED Y'ALL TO CALL SAYING YOU HAVE THEIR MEETING THERE. KIDS COME FROM ALL OVER THE BAY AREA.

>> MY STAFF IS GOING TO SPEAK WITH YOU. HE CAN CHAT WITH YOU ABOUT THAT. THANK YOU SO MUCH I APPRECIATE YOUR COMMENTS.

>> YOU MIGHT WANT TO MOVE THE MIC.

>> I KNOW I CAN'T GROW VERY TALL. HI COUNCIL, WELCOME MAYOR, AND BRILLIANT PRESENTATION. PRACTICAL, EFFECTIVE, REALISTIC FOR GOD'S SAKE. AND NOT OVER EXPENDING WHERE IT CAN'T ACCOMPLISH THE GOAL. SO, MY NAME IS MARIA AND I VOLUNTEERED FOR THE FIRE DEPARTMENT BACK IN THE DAY. YOU WOULD HAVE LAUGHED. IT WAS A HOOT. BUT I'VE DONE CONSTRUCTION FOR SO LONG. AND I'VE HARDENED HOUSES INSTALLING PROPER VENTS, ROOFS, AND WALL CLADDING. PREVENTING HARM AND I DO HAVE AN EXTRA MINUTE FROM A GENTLEMAN IN THE BACK. YES. OKAY. THANK YOU. ONCE I GET GOING I -- ALL RIGHT. YOU KNOW. SO, PREVENTING HARM IS WHERE I'M AT. AND HANDLING DEFERRED MAINTENANCE BECAUSE IT CATCHES UP TO YOU. SO WE ARE DEFINITELY IN IT NOW. I WAS HERE ON THE 1991 FIRE. I WAS PART OF THE BILLING AFTER. -- BUILDING AFTER. I'VE WATCHED FLAMES COME DOWN TOWARD MY PROPERTY. WE DON'T WANT THIS. SO WE CAN'T GUARANTEE -- NOTHING IS GUARANTEED. BUT IF WE DO WHAT WE CAN, WHICH I COMMEND YOU IN PROPOSING. WE CAN DO THIS. WE CAN DO THIS AND WE REALLY MUST. THE OTHER CONCERN IS DENSITY. -- I HAVE

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IS DENSITY. HOMELESS -- I ADVOCATE FOR MORE HOUSING WITH -- FOR PEOPLE WHO HAVE NONE. WE'RE INCREASING THE DENSITY TO SUCH A DEGREE EVEN BEFORE WHICH AND WITH THE CONSTRUCTION IT'S ALMOST IMPOSSIBLE TO DRIVE. EVACUATION, EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS, CIL, CERT I'VE BEEN INVOLVED WITH THAT ALL OVER THE COUNTRY. WE'RE NOT PREPARED ESPECIALLY FOR THE ELDERS AND DISABLED. SO THANK YOU LET'S BE A COMMUNITY AND GOD BLESS BERKELEY AND ALL OF YOU. THANK YOU.

>> A. ISHI: THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR. MY NAME IS MICHELLE. AS A FORMER RESIDENT OF SOUTH LAKE TAHOE WHO EVACUATED TWICE FROM ON COMING FIRE.

I -- PRESENTATION THAT WE'VE HEARD TODAY. I -- IT IS SUCH A PLEASURE TO HEAR AND SEE FENCES FEATURED IN THIS DISCUSSION. AS WELL AS PREEVACUATION ZONE ZERO ENFORCEMENT. THESE ARE ALL WORDS THAT THE REST OF CALIFORNIA NEEDS TO HEAR FROM US. AND I LAWED THE LEADERSHIP THAT BERKELEY IS SHOWING IN DISCUSSING THESE THINGS. WHAT I WOULD LIKE TO HEAR MORE ABOUT IS FIVE-YEAR STRATEGIC PLAN IMPLEMENTATION. WE DID HEAR ABOUT IT BUT I WOULD LIKE TO HEAR MORE. AND UNDER SCORE ASSISTANCE FOR THOSE WHO NEED IT. THE OTHER THING I HAVE NOT HEARD ENOUGH OF IN THIS DISCUSSION THOUGH I KNOW IT'S CERTAINLY IN CONSIDERATION, IS THE ROLE OF OUR NEIGHBORS OAKLAND AND THE UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA CAMPUS. AND FINALLY, I WOULD LIKE TO HEAR MORE IN TERMS OF

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PROPERTY TAX CREDIT. THANK YOU.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. I'M ELIZABETH WATSON. I LIVE ON CAMPUS DRIVE IN DISTRICT SIX. I COME TO YOU TODAY AS I ONCE -- I SAT IN YOUR SEAT IN MY LITTLE COMMUNITY IN SONOMA COUNTY ALL OF WHICH IN A HIGH FIRE ZONE. AND HAVE SEEN PRESENTATIONS WITH VERY SIMILAR DATA PRESENTED TO US BY UC BERKELEY RESEARCHERS. I WAS HORRIFIED WHEN PEOPLE WERE TO RIP OUT THE LANDSCAPING IN THEIR HOUSE. LIKE YOU I HAD A MOMENT AT THE THOUGHT OF WHAT MY INBOX WAS GOING TO LOOK LIKE. AND IT TOOK ME A LITTLE WHILE TO COME AROUND TO IT. I'M SURE BRENT HAD SOME THOUGHTS TOOK INTO CONSIDERATION -- TOO.

>> WE DON'T HAVE A CHOICE. I REALLY HOPE YOU WILL DO THIS. THIS IS ESSENTIAL. AND PLEASE, THANK YOU FOR NOTICING US IN THE HILLS. WE ARE A PART OF THE CITY OF BERKELEY. SOMETIMES I THINK YOU FORGET. AND WE NEED TO TAKE CARE OF THIS. BUT THERE ARE A FEW THINGS THAT I THINK THAT WE OUGHT TO HAVE CARROTS THAT GO ALONG WITH THESE STICKS AND THESE ARE SOME THINGS WE CAME UP WITH MY COMMUNITY IN SONOMA THAT I THOUGHT YOU MIGHT WANT TO THINK ABOUT. ZONE ZERO IS SCARY FROM A LANDSCAPING PERSPECTIVE. SANTA ROSA HAD A LANDSCAPING COMPETITION AND PUT OUT -- DESIGNS. SHOWING PEOPLE IT DOESN'T HAVE TO BE UGLY OR BAD. WE HAVE RESOURCES. USE THEM. WORK WITH THE INSURANCE REGULATORS AND THE INDUSTRY. REALLY RECOGNIZE WHAT IT'S GOING TO DO. A COUPLE OF PEOPLE IN PROPOSED ZONE FOUR CONCERNED ABOUT THE VALUES TO THEIR

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HOMES AFFECTED BY INSURANCE COST. TAKE THAT ON. USE IT AS A POWER. TALK TO THEM. AND MY COMMUNITY -- AND ON THE COAST. NO ONE GETS NEW INSURANCE UNLESS A FAIR PLAN.

>> YOU'RE ACTUALLY OUT OF TIME.

>> REMOVE THE -- CREATE A SCHEDULE FOR PEOPLE YOU WANT TO DO TO REFLECT THE COST AND RECOGNIZE THE NEIGHBOR ENGAGEMENT IS CRITICAL. IF I CAN HARDEN MY HOME AND YOU DON'T, IT DOESN'T MATTER IF YOU SHOW US WHAT TO DO IS FANTASTIC. KEEP IT UP.

>> THANK YOU.

>> HI, MAYOR, COUNCIL. SPEAKING HERE IN MY INDIVIDUAL CAPACITY. I WAS A HIGH SCHOOL STUDENT IN SONOMA COUNTY DURING THE TUBS FIRE IN 2017. I HAD MANY FRIENDS AND TEACHERS WHO LOST THEIR HOMES AND I'M SO -- GRATEFUL FOR THE WORK OF THE CHEER AND THE ENTIRE CHIEF AND THE ENTIRE STAFF. IF THESE HAD BEEN IN PLACE IN SANTA ROSA DURING THE TUBS FIRE, I THINK THE DEVASTATION WOULD HAVE BEEN A LOT LESS SIGNIFICANT. WHEN WE HAVE PEOPLE LIVING IN A -- INTERFACE AS WE DO IN BERKELEY, THERE'S GOING TO BE SIGNIFICANT RECONSTRUCTION AND SIGNIFICANT CHANGES THAT ARE NEEDED. IT'S JUST A MATTER OF DOES THE FIRE BURNING DOWN YOUR HOME FORCE THE CHANGES OR DO IT PROACTIVELY TO AVOID THE DEVASTATION. THANKS.

>> DO WE HAVE COMMENTS ONLINE? WOULD YOU MIND CALLING ON THOSE PEOPLE, PLEASE.

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>> FIRST SPEAKER IS CIBIL HATCH.

>> HI. MAYOR, COUNCIL PEOPLE. THANK YOU SO MUCH. MY NAME IS SYBIL HATCH AND MY PROPERTY BORDERS ON WILDCAT CANYON ROAD. I'M 100% IN FAVOR OF ALL OF THE EMBER PROPOSALS. I WOULD LIKE TO EXPRESS MY INTEREST IN THE SAFE PASSAGE PROGRAM. IF YOU'VE NEVER BEEN TO AT DEAN IT HAS LONG, STRAIGHT WIDE ROADS. EVEN SEE THE EVACUATION WAS CHAOTIC. I'VE LONG BEEN CONCERNED ABOUT THE ABILITY OF OUR NEIGHBORHOOD TO EVACUATE. I WOULD LIKE TO PROPOSE THAT THE CITY DESIGNATE SEVERAL KEY CORRIDORS WITHIN OUR ZONES. FOR EXAMPLE, GRIZZLY PEAKS, SPRUCE AND -- AND GREATLY EXPAND THE RED ZONES. THAT MIGHT NOT BE POPULAR WITH PEOPLE WHO LIVE ON THOSE ZONES BUT MOST HOUSES HAVE TWO CAR GARAGES AND TWO CAR DRIVEWAYS. IN MY OPINION, FOR TOO LONG THEY'VE BEEN USING THE PUBLIC RIGHT-OF-WAY FOR THEIR OWN PRIVATE USE TO STORE THEIR CARS.

>> OKAY.

>> NEXT IS RACHEL.

>> HI. MY NAME IS RACHEL BRADLEY AND I WANT TO MAKE TWO SIMPLE POINTS ABOUT EVACUATION. COMMON SENSE INDICATES WE NEED ROOM FOR A CAR AND FIRE TRUCK TO PASS ON EVERY ROAD. WE NEED STRICT PARKING RESTRICTIONS. WE CAN DO THIS QUICKLY AND CHEAPLY. COUPLE OF DETAILS ABOUT THAT. WHEN YOU TALK ABOUT RED CURBING. YOU NEED TO INCLUDE THE DRIVEWAYS. BECAUSE PEOPLE FEEL FREE TO PARK

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ACROSS THEIR DRIVEWAYS WHEN THEY'RE NOT STRIPED RED WHICH THEY'RE NOT USUALLY. AND THE ONLY ENFORCEMENT YOU CAN GET FOR THAT IS IF THE HOMEOWNER THEMSELVES COMPLAINS. IT WON'T WORK JUST PAINT CURBS RED UNLESS YOU ALSO STOP PEOPLE FROM PARKING ACROSS THEIR DRIVEWAYS AND WE NEED TO CLARIFY THERE'S NO PARK ON SIDEWALKS -- PARKING ON SIDEWALKS. AND MY SECOND POINT IS THE ROAD BETWEEN INSPIRATION POINT AND -- I THINK THAT'S WILDCAT CANYON HAS BEEN CLOSED FOR YEARS. THAT COULD A CRITICAL WAY OUT FOR PEOPLE FROM THE HILLS. I DON'T UNDERSTAND WHY THAT HASN'T BEEN REPAIR AND OPENED.

>> NEXT UP IS CHRIS.

>> YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> HI NAME IS CHRIS I LIVE IN FIRE ZONE ONE AND I'VE DONE SO FOR 40 YEARS. I WAS THE INTERIM -- UNTIL THE GRANT ENDED ON DECEMBER 31ST LAST YEAR. I AM SPEAKING FOR MYSELF. I FULLY SUPPORT THE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT PROPOSAL. BECAUSE OF THE HILLS -- IF THE HILLS BURN, SO DO WE ALL. THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS CHARLES SCAWTHORN.

>> CHARLES YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNMUTE.

>> THANK YOU. SORRY. FIRST MY NAME IS CHARLES. I WISH TO THANK CHIEF FOR AN EXCELLENT PRESENTATION. I'M A STRUCTURAL ENGINEER AND FIVE BOOKS ON URBAN CON -- I JUST RETURNED FROM THE PALISADES FIRES. LIVE ON CRESTEN ROAD IN THE PROPOSED FIRE ZONE.

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TO COMPLY IT WILL COST ME MONEY I WILL SUPPORT THIS MEASURE. A SCENE IN PALISADES WATER SUPPLY IS ALSO CRUCIAL. THE DOWNSIZING OF THE RESERVOIR. BUT -- 20 YEARS AGO WE APPROVED A BOND MEASURE TO BUILD CISTERNS ON THE TOP OF THE HILL AND IT WASN'T BUILT. I CITY TO INSTALL A FIRE FIGHTING WATER TANK ON SUMMIT RESERVOIR SITE FOR FIRE FIGHTING. FURTHERMORE THE SITE ALSO SERVED AS A LAST-RESORT REFUGE IN THE EVENT OF A FIRE. I URGE THE CITY WITH WORKING EAST BAY MUD TO ADD THIS AS AN EXTREME 11 ACRE SATE FOR REV -- SITE FOR REFUGE.

>> NEXT IS RACHEL.

>> RACHEL?

>> YOU ALREADY ON ME AND -- CALLED ON ME AND I SPOKE. VY A SUGGESTION. 10 SECONDS YOU NEED TO HAVE SOMETHING ON SCREEN SHOWING PEOPLE HOW MUCH TIME THEY HAVE LEFT. THANK YOU.

>> SORRY THE CLOCK IN CASE IF YOU HAVE IT OPEN ON YOUR ZOOM I DON'T KNOW IF THEY CAN SEE IT ON THE WEBINAR THOUGH. THERE'S A CLOCK UP HERE. I WROTE AN APP FOR IT.

>> THANK YOU, COUNCIL MEMBER.

>> NEXT IS CANDACE.

>> HI. I'VE BEEN ON THE CLIMATE TEAM OF THE LEAGUE OF WOMEN VOTERS FOR A LONG TIME AND WORKED WITH THE LEAGUE ON WILDFIRES. THIS IS A TERRIFIC PROGRAM. AND I THINK HOWEVER, WE'VE KIND OF DOWNPLAYED THE DANGER TO THE WHOLE CITY FROM WILDFIRE. I

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RECENTLY SAW GIS MAP THAT SHOWED THE BERKELEY MARINA IS VERY HIGH WILDFIRE. THE LAST EVACUATION EVENT WE HAD -- THE WIND CAME FROM THE WEST. SO I JUST WANT TO PUT THAT OUT THERE FOR CONSIDERATION. ALSO, SOMEONE SAID A WORD THAT'S VERY IMPORTANT. REFUGE. WE TALK ABOUT EVACUATION. WHERE ARE PEOPLE GOING TO GO? MY PARTNER AND I DID THE LAST EVACUATION THIS FALL. WE PACKED UP OUR STUFF WE GOT IN THE CAR WE WENT DOWN FROM [INDISCERNIBLE] TO THE ALBANY LIBRARY. IT TOOK 15 MINUTES WITH NO TRAFFIC.

>> THANK YOU. PLEASE CONCLUDES. THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS LAURIE.

>> I'M ONE OF THOSE RED DOTS SEEN IN THE SLIDES. I WOULD BE HAPPY TO COMPLY WITH ALL OF THE RECOMMENDATIONS. I LIVE NEXT TO 50 EUCALYPTUS TREES AND THEY DUMP SO MUCH DEBRIS ON MY PROPERTY THAT IT IS IMPOSSIBLE FOR ME TO BE IN COMPLIANCE WITH THE REGULATIONS UNLESS I AM CLEARING MY PROPERTY DAILY. SO UNLESS THOSE TREES COME DOWN, THERE'S NO WAY THEY CAN BE IN COMPLIANCE. THE SECOND POINT IS I HAVE PREEMPTIVELY EVACUATED ON ALL THREE OCCASIONS IN THE LAST FOUR YEARS. AND I THINK YOU SHOULD SPIN PREEMPTIVE EVACUATION AS A COMMUNITY SERVICE. BECAUSE I THINK IF PEOPLE ARE OUT OF HERE CARS ARE OUT OF HERE. IT WILL BE MUCH EASIER FOR FIRE FIGHTERS TO CONTAIN WHATEVER THEY CAN CONTAIN WITHOUT HAVING TO WORRY ABOUT EVACUATION. I KNOW OF NO ONE ELSE IN THIS ZONE THAT I'M IN THAT EVACUATED. I THINK THERE NEEDS TO

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BE MORE WORK ON SPINNING THAT AS A COMMUNITY SERVICE.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS NANCY RADER.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON. I STRONGLY AGREE WITH THE PREMISE OF THE FIRE DEPARTMENT'S PROPOSAL. WE CAN REALLY ONLY PROTECT OURSELVES IF THE WHOLE COMMUNITY TAKES ACTION. WE NEED COLLECTIVE ACTION. I SUPPORT THE PROPOSAL TO FOCUS FIRST ON FIRE ZONE THREE AND THE NEW ZONE FOUR. AND ALSO MOVE ON TO THE OTHER ZONES. I ALSO WANTED TO HIGHLIGHT THE FIRE SAFE COUNCIL'S RECOMMENDATION THAT THE COUNCIL INCLUDE IN THE PACKAGE OF -- TO DEVELOP A DETAILED FIVE-YEAR AND IF TO CREATE GREATER TRANSPARENCY AROUND THE TAX REVENUES TO ESTABLISH PRESSURABLE GOALS AND TRACT EXPENDITURES TOWARD THE GOAL EACH YEAR.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS MARGOT SMITH.

>> HI. I LIVE ON SHADIC. IT WAS DESTROYED IN THE 1923. OUR HOUSE WAS BUILT IN 1924. MY CONCERN IS WE HAVE A LONG HISTORY OF FIRES HERE IN THE BAY AREA. AND WE REALLY NEED TO WORK ON THESE EVACUATION ROUTES. RECENTLY THEY TRIED TO IMPEDE HOPKINS STREET WHICH IS A MAJOR EVACUATION ROUTE. THEY TRIED TO IMPEDE IT WITH BICYCLE LANES AND WE HAVE OTHER THINGS THAT ARE IMPEDING EVACUATION. FOR EXAMPLE, THE CORNER OF HOPKINS AND THE ALAMEDA HAS ALL THOSE CONCRETE THINGS. THEY PREVENT CARS FROM FLOWING

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OUT OF THE CITY FREELY. AND WE REALLY NEED TO THINK CAREFULLY ABOUT HOW THE BICYCLE LOBBY IS WORKING AGAINST THE FIRE EVACUATION. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS MICHAEL GOLDHABER.

>> HI. I'M VERY MUCH APPRECIATED THE PRESENTATION WHICH WAS EYE OPENING. I LIVE RIGHT NEXT TO TILDUN. I NOTICE THEY'VE DONE SIGNIFICANT CLEARING IN OUR AREA WHERE THERE WAS A FIRE IN 2017. AND I WONDER HOW STRONGLY THE CITY IS WORKING WITH THEM AND MY SECOND QUESTION REALLY CONCERNS EVACUATION. MY WIFE AND I ARE ELDERLY AND EVACUATED. BUT THE LAST TIME WE DID IT, IT HAPPENED TO COINCIDE WITH SOME KIND OF GAME. I'M NOT SURE WHAT AND IT WAS VERY DIFFICULT TO FIRE ANYWHERE TO STAY. SO, IF THERE CAN BE SOME COORDINATION ON THE CITY LEVEL WHEN EVACUATION IS NEEDED IN THE SUGGESTING HOUSE TO -- HOW TO FIND A PLACE TO SPEND THE NIGHT OR WHATEVER IS NEEDED, THAT WOULD BE EXTREMELY IMPORTANT AND HELPFUL. THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS JEFF BLOOMFIELD.

>> THERE. I HAVE A CONCERN WHICH IS ONLY -- CONCERNS OVER THE LAST FEW YEARS BERKELEY'S ENCOURAGEMENT OF ADU PERMITS TO ALLEVIATE HOUSING SHORTAGE AND I DON'T BELIEVE THIS ORDINANCE IS FINE GRAINED ENOUGH TO LOOK AT FIRE ZONES AND I WOULD LIKE THE COUNCIL FOR STAFF TO LOOK AT THAT AND PERHAPS LIMIT OR ENTIRELY

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BEEN A NEW ADU PERMITS WITHIN THE FIRE ZONES. I THINK IT'S SOMETHING THAT REQUIRES SOME STUDY BUT DEFINITELY A LIMITING OF NEW ADUS BECAUSE THEY BRING MORE VEHICLES AND MORE PEOPLE THAT HAVE TO USE OUR ALREADY INADEQUATE EVACUATION ROUTES.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS GEORGE PORTER.

>> SPEAKING FOR MYSELF BUT I'VE SPENT MANY YEARS ON THE COMMISSION ON AGEING AND I JUST WANT TO SPEAK AS OTHERS HAVE TO THIS IDEA OF EVACUATION. IN AN AREA WHERE MANY PEOPLE ARE ELDERLY. AND REALLY CAN'T LEAVE THEIR HOMES THAT EASILY. PEOPLE HAVE ASSISTED DEVICES. THEY HAVE VARIOUS REASONS THEY ARE -- ARE THERE. FOR MYSELF I'M HAVING KNEE SURGERY, SOON AND I'M DOING IT KNEE REPLACEMENT DURING THESE WINTER MONTHS BECAUSE LIVING IN THE HILLS I'M FRANKLY AFRAID OF BEING LAID UP DURING THE TIME IN WHICH I MAY NEED TO RUN OUT OF MY HOUSE. AND HELP MY WIFE TO DO THE SAME. AND I JUST THINK, REMEMBERING THAT AND SETTING UP SOME WAY FOR ELDERS TO BE ABLE TO RELOCATE AND ALSO THE IDEA THAT THOSE WHO CAN MORE EASILY --

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS FORMER MAYOR SHIRLEY DEAN.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME NOW?

>> YES.

>> THANK YOU. THANK YOU FOR THIS OPPORTUNITY. I HAVE SERVED ON

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THE PLANNING COMMISSION, ZONING BOARD. I SERVED AS COUNCIL MEMBER AT LARGE COUNCIL DISTRICT FIVE COUNSEL AND AS MAYOR -- I CURRENTLY SERVE ON SEVERAL NONPROFIT ORGANIZATIONS BUT I'M SPEAKING AS AN INDIVIDUAL. I URGE YOU TO GO BACK TO THE CONCEPT OF THE CARRYING CAPACITY OF THE LAND THAT YOU'RE TALKING ABOUT. IT IS EXTREMELY IMPORTANT THAT WE UNDERSTAND THIS BECAUSE SOME STREETS NEED TO BE CLEAR THROUGHOUT SO THAT AMBULANCES AND MEDICAL VEHICLES AND THE LIKE CAN GET THROUGH. AS WELL AS FOR EVACUATION. I URGE YOU TO INVOLVE A PANEL OF PEOPLE FROM THE COMMISSIONS TO WORK ON THE FINER DETAILS OF THIS AS YOU GO ALONG BECAUSE TIMES CHANGE OVER THE NEXT FEW YEARS. AND IT'S IMPORTANT THAT WE STAY ON TOP OF IT. ONE CAR EVACUATING CAN HOLD UP DOZENS AND DOZENS OF PEOPLE AND PUT THEM IN SERIOUS DANGER. REACH OUT TO ALL OF THE COMMISSIONS AND DEVELOP A PANEL THAT CAN WORK ON THIS ON A -- ON AN ON-GOING BASIS.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT IS CHERYL, FORMER COUNCIL MEMBER.

>> I HAVE TO SAY THE FIRE DEPARTMENT. IT'S A GOOD-LOOKING CREW. ANYWAY. WHAT ABOUT THE FLAT LANDS? BERKELEY DOESN'T JUST CONSIST OF THE HILLS. WILDFIRES CAN HAPPEN ANYWHERE. WE HAVE A JET FUEL LINE GOING UP ONE OF OUR STREETS IN BERKELEY [INDISCERNIBLE] THE HIGH SCHOOL IS THERE. [INDISCERNIBLE] THE FLAT LANDS AS FARS I HEARD. I WAS LISTENING AT HOME. WITH ALL THE INFILL, ADUS

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ALL THE THINGS I DON'T SEE DEFENSIBLE SPACE AROUND THESE HOUSES AND THAT'S, YOU KNOW, PARADISE, ALTADENA THE PALISADES. THAT WASN'T -- THAT COULD HAPPEN HERE AND YOU'RE NOT EVEN TALKING ABOUT THE FLAT LANDS.

>> THANK YOU.

>> THAT'S A BIG MESS.

>> I UNDERSTAND I'M ON A TIME CRUNCH I THINK YOU SHOULD BE FLEXIBLE WITH THAT, TOO.

>> THANK YOU.

>> NEXT SPEAKER ON ZOOM IS KELLEY -- KELLEY DROPPED OFF. NOW IT'S DEBBIE.

>> HELLO, MY NAME IS DEBBIE SANDERSON. MY COMMENT IS PRIMARILY FOR THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND THE COLLEAGUES WHO HELP THEM. THIS HAS BEEN THE MOST INFORMATIVE MEETING I'VE GONE TO. AND IT TOOK A LOT OF COURAGE I SUSPECT FOR THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND THEIR COLLEAGUES TO COME FORWARD WITH THIS PROPOSAL. IT IS DRIVEN BY SCIENCE, DRIVEN BY EVIDENCE AND I THINK YOU HAVE RAISED THE BAR FOR PRESENTATIONS AND PROPOSALS THAT OTHER DEPARTMENTS GIVE. AND I CONGRATULATE YOU FOR -- HEARTEDLY. FOR MAKING THESE RECOMMENDATIONS AND SUPPORT THE RECOMMENDATIONS. THANK YOU.

>> OKAY. LAST SPEAKER ON ZOOM IS RICHARD.

>> HI. I HAVE A FEW QUICK COMMENTS. I WAS FORMERLY SENIOR DEPUTY CITY ATTORNEY IN OAKLAND AND I HANDLED PUBLIC NUISANCE.

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>> THE LAST EVACUATION WE EVACUATED BUT HARDLY ANYBODY ELSE DID. A LOT OF PEOPLE DID NOT GET THE NOTICES TO EVACUATE. A LOT OF PEOPLE WERE SURPRISED. THERE NEEDS TO BE WORK ON THE NOTIFICATION SYSTEM. SECONDLY YOU NEED TO IDENTIFY EVACUATION ROUTES. I KNOW THE FIRE DEPARTMENT THINKS YOU CAN'T IDENTIFY THEM IN ADVANCE BUT YOU CAN DESIGNATE CERTAIN ROUTES FOR EVACUATION. -- DOING THE RED STRIPES AROUND THE STREETS GREAT BUT SOME OF THOSE STREETS SHOULD BE CLEARED UP -- DESIGNATED AS ONE WAY. EUCALYPTUS TREES, DECLARE THEM A PUBLIC NUISANCE BECAUSE THEY ARE. THAT WILL GIVE YOU MORE AUTHORITY TO GET THEM REMOVED AT PROPERTY OWNERS OR PUBLIC EXPENSE. WE'VE BEEN DEALING WITH THIS FOR SO MANY YEARS. THANK YOU.

>> OKAY.

>> WE HAVE ONE MORE. SPEAKER IS.

>> ALL RIGHT.

>> HI. THERE HAS BEEN AN ISSUE RAISED IN OUR NEIGHBORHOOD TO CHANGE THE MEDIAN SPACE TO A PARK. AND TO USE $150,000 TO ASSESS THAT.

>> YOU CAN PULL THE MICROPHONE CLOSER TO YOU.

>> AND THERE WAS A LETTER SENT TO THE CITY COUNCIL SAYING THAT OUR NEIGHBORHOOD THE $250 -- I'M SORRY IS THIS RELEVANT TO THE SPECIAL MEETING CONTENT.

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>> IT'S RELEVANT TO HOW FUNDS ARE BEING USED AND WHETHER THE FUNDS SHOULD BE USED TO ASSESS A --

>> WE HAVE A GENERAL MEETING AFTER THIS SPECIAL MEETING AND YOU'RE WELCOME TO GIVE YOUR PUBLIC COMMENT THERE DURING NONAGENDA ITEMS. MY STAFF IS ALSO HERE IF YOU WOULD LIKE TO SPEAK WITH THEM. BUT I LIKE TO MOVE ON TO COUNCIL COMMENTS THIS IT'S NOT RELEVANT TO THIS TOPIC.

>> THANKS FOR COMING. I APPRECIATE YOUR COMMENT STILL.

>> DO WE HAVE MORE? OKAY.

>> ALL RIGHT. I WOULD LIKE TO MOVE ON TO COUNCIL COMMENTS AND I WOULD LIKE TO START WITH COUNCIL BLACKABY.

>> B. BLACKABY: AND THANK YOU TO THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND WORK YOU'VE PUT INTO THE PRESENTATION AND THE PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT THAT LED US TO THIS POINT. I KNOW IT'S BEEN AN ENORMOUS AMOUNT OF WORK. WE CAN SEE THE RESULT AND THE RESULT IS A SOLID PLAN. I THINK WE WILL ALL SUPPORT AND THE COMMUNITY IS SUPPORTING. IN ADDITION TO THE PRESENTATION I WANT TO THANK ALL OF THE NEIGHBORS IN DISTRICT SIX AND MANY OF THE PEOPLE WHO HAVE COME OUT TONIGHT TO EXPRESS THEIR SUPPORT, THEIR FEEDBACK ON THE PLAN. AND ALSO CONSTRUCTIVE CRITICISM. AS FORMER COUNCIL MEMBER WENGRAF SAID NO PLAN IS PERFECT. IT'S ONLY IMPROVES IF WE HAVE FEEDBACK. I'M IN SUPPORT OF ALL THE RECOMMENDATIONS THAT HAVE BEEN MADE HERE. I ALSO WANTED TO HIGHLIGHT THE SAFE PASSAGES

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PROGRAM. AS MUCH OF THE PLAN HAS BEEN TALKED ABOUT IS PREPARATION IN TERMS OF MOMENT HARDEN -- HOME HARDENING, ZONE ZERO AND ANTICIPATING THE NEEDS AROUND EVACUATION, INGRESS AND EGRESS IS IMPORTANT. I ENCOURAGE MY COLLEAGUES TO SUPPORT THAT AS WELL TONIGHT. I JUST ALSO WANT TO SAY, I'M COMMITTED TO SORT OF SEEING THIS THROUGH WITH YOU ALL. THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT PART OF THE PACKAGE. THE PART THAT'S GOING TO REQUIRE THE MOST SACRIFICE AND WORK I THINK ON BEHALF OF OUR NEIGHBORS. IT'S NOT THE ONLY THING. I KNOW WE ALL RECOGNIZE THAT. I AGREE THAT FINANCING IS ABSOLUTELY CRITICAL MAKING IT EASIER FOR HOMEOWNERS TO DO THE WORK AND REMOVING THE BARRIERS THAT WILL INHIBIT THAT IS REALLY CRITICAL. SO ONE OF MY GOALS OVER THE NEXT FEW MONTHS WORKING WITH THE TEAM IS FIGURING OUT WAYS THAT WE CAN MAKE THAT PIECE EASIER. FINANCING IS AN IMPORTANT PART OF THAT. EVACUATION PLANNING AS WE MENTIONED THE IMPORTANT. I KNOW WE'RE WAITING ON THE RESULTS OF EVACUATION STUDY. I KNOW WE WON'T BE SURPRISED BY WHAT THAT STUDY SAYS. BUT BEING THOUGHTFUL, PREPARED AND COMMUNICATING BACK TO OUR NEIGHBORS WHAT THE EVACUATION PLAN IS IN ADDITION TO PREEVACUATION IS IMPORTANT. ECHOING WHAT WE'VE HEARD. WORKING WITH OUR PARTNERS WITH THE PARK DISTRICT AND UC BERKELEY, BERKELEY LAB. THANKS TO THE GREAT WORK THAT FIRE SAFE COUNCIL AND FIRE WISE COMMUNITIES ARE DOING. THERE'S A REAL OPPORTUNITY TO PARTNER HERE. WE'RE STRONGER WHEN WE WORK

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TOGETHER. ONE OF THE THINGS I'VE BEEN REALLY IED BY -- NY THE LAST COUPLE OF MONTHS THE CLOSER COORDINATION BETWEEN THE DEPARTMENT AND ALL THESE NEIGHBORHOOD ORGANIZATIONS. THERE ARE 13 FIRE WISE COMMUNITIES IN OR NEAR ZONE FOUR. THESE ARE NEIGHBORS THAT HAVE ALREADY SAID WE TO -- WANT TO ORGANIZE OURSELVES AND DO THE HOME HARDENING AND FUEL REDUCTION WORK. WE HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY TO USE THAT GRASSROOTS ENGAGEMENT IN COMBINATION WITH THE FIRE DEPARTMENT TO END UP IN A GOOD PLACE. I WANT TO HELP STRENGTHEN THAT COORDINATION. LAST THING I WILL SAY, WHAT I THINK IS SO IMPORTANT ABOUT THIS WORK AND THE CHIEF MENTIONED IT IN OUR PREVIOUS MEETINGS. SO MUCH OF THIS IS ABOUT BUYING TIME. THAT, YOU KNOW, THE SOLUTION WILL NOT BE PERFECT AS MUCH AS WE HOPE THAT WE CAN SAVE EVERY HOME IN THIS PROCESS, IT'S UNLIKELY THAT WE WILL BE ABLE TO SAVE EVERY HOME. BUT WE WANT TO BUY TIME TO EN MASSE THE RESPONSE TO SUPPORT THE FIRE DEPARTMENT AND THE PARTNERS THAT WILL COME TO OUR AID IN A DISASTER LIKE THIS TO PREVENT THE FIRE FROM ROARING DOWN THE HILL AND THE REST OF BERKELEY. I REALLY SEE THIS AS ALL THE CITY ISSUE. I APPRECIATE THE SUPPORT FROM NEIGHBORS AND THE COMMUNITY AND HOPE TO HAVE THE SUPPORT OF MY COLLEAGUES AS WELL. THANK YOU.

>> A. ISHI: THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU FOR THOSE COMMENTS. FIRST AND FOREMOST I WANT TO

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EXPRESS MY GRATITUDE TO CHIEF SPRIG AND THE ENTIRE BERKELEY FIRE DEPARTMENT FOR DEVELOPING THESE THOUGHT-OUT PROPOSALS AND PRESENTING THEM SO WELL TONIGHT. I KNOW THIS IS DEEPLY PERSONAL ISSUE FOR MANY OF YOU. IT HAS TO DO WITH OUR HOMES, LIVES AND THE LIVES OF OUR LOVED ONES. I WANT YOU TO KNOW THIS IS VERY PERSONAL FOR ME AS WELL. MY PARENTS WHO ARE IN THEIR 80S LIVE ON KEELER NOT QUITE IN ZONE FOUR BUT NOT FAR AWAY AND THE HOUSE I GREW UP IN. NOW I LIVE DOWN THE HILL ON THE EDGE OF THE FIRE ZONE. MY HEART IS ROOTED IN THE PART WE'RE TALKING ABOUT.

>> I COULD HAVE MOVED HERE LAST YEAR. BUT THE FACT IS THAT I'M IN THIS JOB AND IT'S A JOB TO TAKE SERIOUSLY AND THAT MEANS I HAVE A MORAL IMPERATIVE TO USE MY BEST JUDGMENT AND STRONGEST ADVOCACY TO KEEP OUR COMMUNITY SAFE. THAT'S WHAT WE'RE ALL HERE TO DO PRIMARILY. SO, I KNOW THIS IS A LOT TO ASK. I WOULDN'T BE ASKING IF I DIDN'T THINK IT WAS IN THE BEST INTEREST OF OUR COMMUNITY AND BECAUSE IT'S FOR OUR COMMUNITY IT HAS TO BE DONE BY ALL OF US AS A COMMUNITY. SO COLLECTIVE ACTION AND CARING FOR ONE ANOTHER IS WHERE BERKELEY SHINES. IT'S ONE OF THE VALUES THAT MAKES THIS SUCH A WONDERFUL PLACE TO LIVED. AND LET'S NOT FORGET THAT. I CAN PROMISE YOU IT WILL NOT BE EASY BUT IS NECESSARY. I WILL SAY WE'RE FORTUNATE TO HAVE ONE OF THE MOST SOPHISTICATED WELL-EQUIPPED FIRE DEPARTMENTS IN THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA. I CANNOT BACK THAT UP WITH DATA BUT I'M CERTAIN IT'S

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TRUE. NOW IS THE TIME TO FOLLOW THE SCIENCE AND SUPPORT OUR EXPERTS IN THIS CRITICAL LIFE SAVING WORK. THANK YOU.

>> A. ISHI: THANK YOU. WE'RE MOVING ON TO COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT.

>> B. BARTLETT: I WANT TO THANK THE TEAM FOR YOUR DILIGENT WORK. A WELL-REASONED WELL-POSITIONED PROPOSAL COVERS NEARLY EVERY AT INSPECTED OF KEEPING -- ASPECT OF KEEPING US SAFE HERE. THE ONE THAT KEEPS COMING UP AND THAT CAME UP YEARS AGO YOU MAY RECALL WHEN WE WORKED ON THE OMNIBUS PLAN IN 2017. JUST THE EXPENSE. THAT'S THE -- THERE'S A KEY ELEMENT HERE. THE EXPENSE. THE FILING OPTIONS. I THOUGHT A LOT ABOUT THIS. I THINK WE MAY NEED TO CONSIDER CREATING A SPECIAL ASSESSMENT DISTRICT TO FUND THE HOME HARDENING. FOR EVERYONE THERE. AND THEN EVEN CONCEIVING POSSIBLE COMBINING THAT WITH A CITY WIDE WHERE YOU CAN DO INFRASTRUCTURE AROUND EVACUATION AND FIRE SAFETY MEASURES FOR THE WHOLE CITY. SO I THINK WE SHOULD LOOK AT THIS. THAT'S MY POINT. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI. THANK YOU TO OUR FIRE CHIEF AND EVERYONE GIVING US THIS DETAILED PRESENTATION TODAY. I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE OUR CONCERN FOR THOSE WHO HAVE BEEN DISPLACED AND KILLED BY THE FIRES IN LA. I KNOW MANY OF US HAVE FRIENDS WHO HAVE BEEN DIRECTLY AFFECTED. AND I'M GRATEFUL IT IS INSPIRING OUR COMMUNITY TO CONTINUE TO TAKE THIS WILDFIRE THREAT

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OR THIS URBAN FIRE THREAT VERY SERIOUSLY. I KNOW YOU GAVE DETAILED PRESENTATION. I JUST WANTED TO ASK YOU A FEW QUESTIONS. ONE IS AROUND STAFFING. DOES YOUR PROPOSAL INCLUDE STAFFING AND COULD YOU GO OVER THAT?

>> YEAH ABSOLUTELY.

>> IT DOES INCLUDE THE REQUEST FOR YOU ALL TO AFFIRM THE RECOMMENDATIONS IN THE I CAN DETAIL WHAT THOSE ARE AT A HIGH LEVEL. ONE IS TO COMPLETE THE TRANSITION OF FIRE DEPARTMENTS OFF OF OUR AMBULANCE TO UP STAFF KEY COMPANIES FROM THREE TO FOUR PEOPLE. THAT IS UNDER WAY AND BUDGET NEUTRAL. THE SECOND IS TO INCREASE STAFFING ON ALL OF THE HILL FIRE COMPANIES DURING -- AT A COST OF ABOUT $4,000 A DAY. THAT IS NOT FUNDED BUT SOMETHING THAT IS RELATIVELY RARE AND COULD BE ABSORBED. THE -- IN THE FINAL RECOMMENDATION IS TO ADD A SECOND OPERATIONAL FIELD COMMANDER 24-7. THAT IS SOMETHING NECESSARY FOR DAY-TO-DAY OPERATIONS AND ALSO FOR LARGER INCIDENTS LIKE WILDFIRES. THAT IS ONE SIGNIFICANT COST THAT IS UNFUNDED.

>> IN TERMS OF PROCESS, ARE WE GOING TO LOOK AT THE POSSIBILITY OF FUNDING THESE STAFFING REQUESTS DURING THE BUDGET PROCESS?

>> IF I COULD TAKE THAT ONE. THAT'S THE IDEA. THERE ARE A LOT OF COMPETING PRIORITIES AND WE HAVE A FAIRLY SIGNIFICANT BUDGET DEFICIT. AS WE CONSIDER HOW TO MOVE FORWARD WITH THE BUDGET AND MEETING THOSE PRIORITIES THIS WILL BE PART OF THAT DISCUSSION.

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>> THANK YOU MR. CITY MANAGER. I WANTED TO ASK ABOUT SOMETHING WE READ AND HEARD ABOUT IN THE NEWS OUT OF LA WHICH IS THIS ISSUE OF PREPOSITIONING OUR FIRE APPARATUS AND STAFF YOU KNOW, DURING THOSE HIGH FIRE HAZARD DAYS. DO WE HAVE A POLICY AROUND THAT? CAN YOU SHARE YOUR THINKING ON WHEN YOU MIGHT DO THAT?

>> ABSOLUTELY. I'LL TALK ABOUT THE LOCAL -- MUNICIPAL RESPONSE. FOR FIRE WEATHER WE HAVE A POLICY THAT DRIVES WHAT ACTION WE TAKE. THAT INCLUDES UP STAFFING ADMINISTRATIVELY IN OUR OFFICE OF [INDISCERNIBLE] SERVICES. ALSO IN THE FIELD. SO IN ANTICIPATION OF IGNITION WE DO UP STAFF IN THE CITY CURRENTLY AND WE MAKE WITH OTHER NEIGHBORING JURISDICTIONS. THERE'S COORDINATION AS A COUNTY LEVEL.

>> BEYOND THE WORK THAT'S DONE BY EACH INDIVIDUAL AGENCY THE REGIONAL COORDINATORS WORKING WITH THE CALLOSE SYSTEM APPLY AND RECEIVE APPROVAL TO UP STAFF STRIKE TEAMS AND TASK FORCES.

>> THERE ARE ALSO STATE RESOURCES BY CAL FIRE. THEY ARE MORE LIKELY TO BE DRAWN AWAY. THE OES FUNDING OF PREPOSITIONS TASK FORCE WITH STATE FUNDS AND LOCAL RESOURCES ARE TETHERED WITH THE GEOGRAPHY AND REMAIN IN PLACE DURING HIGH WIND EFFECTS AND IMPROVED IN THE FALL.

>> SO ON THIS --

>> I THINK YOU HAD A SLIDE OF THE MAP OF THE AREA YOU'RE

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PROPOSING FOR THAT. CORRECT ME IF I'M WRONG. WE HAVEN'T SPECIFIED WHAT SORT OF ENFORCEMENT WE WILL HAVE FOR THE HOME HARDENING IN THAT. HAVE WE? …IF I'M, CORRECT ME IF I'M WRONG, SO WE HAVEN'T SPECIFIED WHAT SORT OF ENFORCEMENT WE WILL HAVE FOR THE HOME HARDENING, HAVE WE?

>> FOR THE HOME HARDENING, WE CAN'T RETROACTIVELY MODIFICATIONS TO STRUCTURES BUILT, THEY WERE LEGAL WHEN THEY WERE BUILT AND WE CAN'T RETROACTIVELY ENFORCE. WE ARE LEFT WITH OPTIONS, WHEN REMODELS OF PERMITS ARE PULLED. THERE'S THE SALE BUT THERE'S COMPLICATIONS WE NEED TO WORK THROUGH.

>> R. KESARWANI: WHEN I SAID HOME HARDENING, I MEANT THE DEFENSIVE SPACE AROUND THE HOMES FOR FIRE ZONE FOUR.

>> IN TERMS OF ENFORCEMENT, IT WOULD BE ADOPTED IF YOU SO CHOOSE IT WOULD BE ADOPTED INTO THE FIRE CODE. AND THEN THAT WOULD FOLLOW OUR NORMAL THERE'S A DEFINED INSPECTION, REINSPECTIONS, WARNINGS, NOTIFICATIONS AND EVENTUALLY CITATIONS THAT WOULD RESULT.

>> R. KESARWANI: THERE'S ALREADY AN ESTABLISHED PRACTICE IF WE ADOPT THAT FIRE ZONE FOUR.

>> RIGHT.

>> R. KESARWANI: AS A NEIGHBOR I SHARE TWO WOOD FENCES WITH THOSE NEIGHBORS. WHAT -- YOU SHOWED THOSE MODELS OF THE WROTE IRON FENCE. OBVIOUSLY THAT'S SEE-THROUGH, YOU CAN SEE THROUGH

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THAT TYPE OF FENCE. I WONDER FOR JUST THE PUBLIC, DO YOU HAVE AT THIS TIME A RECOMMENDATION OF WHAT TYPE OF MATERIAL YOU WOULD RECOMMEND BETWEEN TWO PROPERTIES THAT'S NOT A WOOD FENCE THAT WOULD PROVIDE PRIVACY?

>> I THINK ONE OF THE IDEAS WE HAVE HAD IS WORK WITH LOCAL ARTISANS TO COME UP WITH METAL FENCES THAT ARE MORE ATTRACTIVE THAN THE ONES YOU SEE GENERALLY AT HOME DEPOT. THERE ARE A VARIETY OF NON-COMBUSTIBLE METAL FENCES OR FENCES MADE FROM OTHER NON-COMBUSTIBLE MATERIALS RATED BY THE STATE AS SUCH THAT ARE -- YOU CAN'T SEE THROUGH THEM. YOU HAVE THE PRIVACY BUT YOU HAVE THE FIRE PROTECTION.

>> R. KESARWANI: OKAY, I WANT PEOPLE TO BE AWARE OF THAT, ESPECIALLY IF THEY ARE IN FIRE ZONES AND YOUR WOOD FENCE IS FAILING. I THINK THAT'S THE EASIEST TIME TO MAKE THESE IMPROVEMENTS IS WHEN YOU NEED TO REPLACE SOMETHING. HOPEFULLY, WE CAN THINK ABOUT HOW TO ADVISE AND EDUCATE PEOPLE ABOUT THE RIGHT THING TO USE THAT WILL STILL GIVE THEM THE PRIVACY THEY WANT AND STILL BE FIRE-RESISTANT. OKAY, WELL THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR ALL OF THESE PROPOSALS. I WANT TO JUST VOICE MY SUPPORT FOR THEM AND SUPPORT FOR OUR CONTINUED WORK TO BE A RESILIENT COMMUNITY. THANK YOU SO MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT?

>> M. HUMBERT: THANK YOU. I WANT TO THANK OUR FIRE DEPARTMENT.

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OUR COMMUNITY OWES YOU A DEBT OF GRATITUDE FOR THE WORK YOU DO, RESPONDING TO EMERGENCIES EVERY DAY, THE WHOLE DEPARTMENT AND WORKING TO MAKE OUR COMMUNITIES SAFER AND MORE RESILIENT IN THE FACE OF DISASTERS, WHICH WE FACE MULTIPLE FORMS OF THEM IN THIS TOWN. WORKING ON THIS AND STARTING REALLY WITH 1A, WHICH IS THE FIRE CODE AMENDMENTS. WORKING ON THIS HAS BEEN AN ITERATIVE PROCESS WITH THE FIRE DEPARTMENT. AND I BELIEVE THAT BASED ON SOME QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS WITH STAFF, THERE ARE ALREADY SOME PROPOSED REVISIONS THAT WILL IMPROVE THE MEASURE. I THINK ONE OVERARCHING THING I WANT TO NOTE IS THERE NEEDS TO BE GREATER CLARITY AROUND PERFORMANCE-BASED STANDARDS. I THINK IT NEEDS TO BE CLEAR THIS WILL NEVER CREATE MORE STRINGENT REQUIREMENTS FOR HOME OWNERS THAN EXIST IN THE CODE. MAYBE I'M GETTING TOO FAR IN THE WEEDS. I THINK THERE NEEDS TO BE MORE CONSIDERATION FOR WHAT WOULD SUPPORT THESE JUDGMENTS. ALLOWING FOR PURELY SUBJECTIVE RELAXATIONS OF REQUIREMENTS RAISE SOME DUE PROCESS AND OTHER QUESTIONS IN MY MIND AND I WOULD LIKE TO SEE THIS EXPLORED MORE THOROUGHLY AND REWORKED. IT WOULD BE REALLY HELPFUL TO HAVE A CHART SHOWING WHICH PARTS APPLY TO WHICH BERKELEY FIRE HAZARD ZONES SO SOMEBODY CAN TAKE A QUICK LOOK AND SAY THIS APPLIES TO ME OR DOESN'T APPLY TO ME. I THINK THAT'S WHAT PEOPLE WOULD LIKE TO GO TO FIRST. I RECOGNIZE WE ARE TRYING TO ACT WITH A SENSE OF URGENCY AND WE INTEND TO MAKE SUBSTANTIAL CHANGES IN OUR FIRE

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CODE. IT MAKES SENSE THE FIRST DRAFT WOULD STILL NEED SOME ADJUSTMENT. I'M HOPING SUBSEQUENT VERSIONS WILL COME WITH LEAD TIME AND I KNOW WE ARE MOVING QUICKLY, AHEAD OF ANOTHER COUNCIL MEETING. WITH RESPECT TO THE SECOND PART OF EMBER, AND THAT'S BUILDING CODE AMENDMENTS, I REALLY DO APPROVE OF STAFF MOVING FORWARD WITH GRAFTING THEM, WITHOUT HAVING THE DETAILS I CAN'T REALLY SPEAK ABOUT PARTICULARS. I WANT TO EMPHASIZE WE NEED TO BE CONSCIENTIOUS OF COST, ESPECIALLY FOR EXISTING HOMEOWNERS WHO MAY BE HOUSE RICH BUT CASH POOR. I'VE SEEN THAT IN THE HILLS IN PARTICULAR. HOUSE RICH AND CASH POOR. TYPICALLY THESE REQUIREMENTS ARE TRIGGERED BY REBUILDS OR RENOVATIONS BUT SOMETIMES RENOVATIONS ARE INVOLUNTARY LIKE IF WATER DAMAGE OCCURS AND ROOF REPLACEMENTS NEED TO HAPPEN ON A REGULAR SCHEDULE. I WANT US TO BE CONSCIENTIOUS WHEN AND HOW WE ARE IMPOSING ADDITIONAL COSTS. FINALLY, ON THE PART OF THE PROPOSAL, THE LEAVE EARLY AND FIRE DEPARTMENT STAFFING, I THINK TO THE NATIONAL WEATHER SERVICE AND NOAA CONSULTATION MAKES SENSE. THOUGH I WOULD ENCOURAGE THE FIRE DEPARTMENT TO SEEK BACK UPS AND SECOND OPINIONS GIVEN WHAT MAY BE HAPPENING WITH FEDERAL AGENCIES IN THE COMING MONTHS. I TRIED TO PULL UP THE NOAA WEBSITE THE OTHER DAY AND IT SAID IT DIDN'T EXIST. THANK YOU, TRUMP ADMINISTRATION. WITH RESPECT TO FIRE DEPARTMENT STAFFING, OF COURSE WE WANT TO STAFF OUR DEPARTMENT AT THE OPTIMUM LEVEL.

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AND REFLECTING SOME OF THE COMMENTS MADE BY COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI, WE KNOW THAT WE HAVE A CITY BUDGET CRUNCH AND THAT ANY HELP FROM THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT MAY POOF INTO NON-EXISTENCE. I'M OPEN TO APPROVING THESE AS GOALS BUT I WANT TO MAKE SURE IT'S PART OF THE LARGER BUDGET PROCESS AND IT SOUNDS LIKE BASED ON WHAT WE HEARD FROM THE CITY MANAGER THAT IT WILL BE. BUT THAT'S ALL I HAVE. THANKS AGAIN FOR ALL THE INCREDIBLE WORK THAT YOU HAVE DONE SO FAR. I'M JUST DEEPLY GRATEFUL. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB?

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU SO MUCH, MADAM MAYOR. AND THANK YOU FOR THE EXCELLENT AND SCIENCE-INFORMED PRESENTATION. THANK YOU TO THE MEMBERS OF THE COMMUNITY THAT HAVE COME HERE TODAY TO SPEAK IN SUPPORT OF THIS VERY IMPORTANT TOPIC. I REALLY APPRECIATED TO THE PRESENTATION THAT OUR OFFICE RECEIVED FROM CHIEF SPRAGUE AND DEPUTY CHIEF ARNOLD. AND I HAVE TO TELL YOU, I SPENT 12 YEARS IN THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT AND MAYBE WHAT'S LEFT OF IT RIGHT NOW, AS A NUCLEAR ENGINEER. I CAN'T THINK OF ANYTHING THAT HAS SCARED ME MORE THAN THE SLIDES OF FIRE PROGRESSION THAT YOU SHOWED WHEN WE MET AND AGAIN TODAY. I HAD AN OPPORTUNITY. TO SPEND TIME IN PARADISE TO TRY TO HELP ITS LOCAL ECONOMY BY STAYING THERE. AND THIS WAS TWO YEARS AFTER THE FIRE THAT IT EXPERIENCED. IT WAS HORRIFIC JUST HOW RAVAGED IT STILL WAS. I THINK ABOUT WHEN

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GROWING UP IN SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, AS A KID, A FIRE CAME WITHIN SEVERAL HUNDRED YARDS OUR HOME. MY FAMILY'S FIRST HOME. AND I STILL FEEL TRAUMATIZED BY WHEN I REMEMBER THAT. SO ALL THAT TO SAY I STRONGLY SUPPORT ALL FOUR PHASES OF THIS PLAN. AND I THANK MY COLLEAGUES, COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY AND OTHERS WHO HAVE COME UP WITH THE ADDITIONAL PROPOSAL. I STILL REMEMBER, YES, I WILL CONFESS THAT I ONCE TOOK MY CAR OUT TO THE HILLS FOR AN EVENT. AND I WAS ABOUT TO PARK. THERE WAS LIKE SINGLE-FILE PARKING. AND THEN SOMEONE DOUBLE PARKED IN THE OPEN ROAD, I GUESS THEY WERE DROPPING SOMETHING OFF. AND THEN A FIRE ENGINE CAME DOWN THE HILL WITH LIGHTS. AND I'M GLAD I WAS STILL SITTING IN MY CAR, I WAS ABLE TO PARK IN SOMEONE ELSE'S DRIVEWAY SO THE FIRE ENGINE COULD TRY TO GET AROUND, AND THEY STILL WEREN'T ABLE TO. SO YES, I ABSOLUTELY SUPPORT THAT FOURTH PHASE, OR FOURTH PROPOSAL AS WELL. ITEM 1D. I HAD A FEW SOME OF THESE ARE GOING TO BE QUESTIONS, OTHERS ARE COMMENTS. AND FOR TIME I'M JUST GOING TO GO THROUGH THEM QUICKLY. AND I WILL LET STAFF DECIDE IF YOU WISH TO RESPOND TO ANY OF IT NOW, OR WHEN WE COME BACK HERE WITH THE ACTION PHASE OF THIS PROPOSAL. SO FIRST OF ALL, AROUND THE DOLLARS AND CENTS ISSUE, I WAS CURIOUS, YOU MENTIONED IN YOUR PRESENTATION WITH THE LEAVE EARLY PART OF THE PLAN, THERE WERE SOME ELEMENTS THAT WERE NOT YET FUNDED BY THE CITY. I WOULD BE CURIOUS TO BETTER UNDERSTAND WHAT THOSE WERE AND HOW MUCH THEY

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WOULD COST. FOR THE CAL FIRE GRANTS, I WAS CURIOUS HOW MUCH IT WOULD BE PER HOME. I ALSO WANTED TO UNDERSTAND HOW MUCH OF THE CURRENT FUNDING FOR FIRE PREVENTION AND MITIGATION COMES FROM THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT. OBVIOUSLY, WE CANNOT EXPECT THAT FUNDING TO BE THERE, SADLY, IN THE NEXT FOUR YEARS. THAT LEADS ME TO TALK ABOUT OPPORTUNITIES TO LEVERAGE WHAT ELSE EXISTS. FOR EXAMPLE, THERE IS CURRENTLY AN INVESTMENT TAX CREDIT OF UP TO 30% WHEN YOU PUT ROOFTOP SOLAR ON, WHICH TYPICALLY HAPPENS, OR OFTEN HAPPENS AS PART OF A LARGER ROOF REPLACEMENT PROJECT. SO HOW CAN SOMETHING LIKE THAT BE LEVERAGED? ARE THERE OPPORTUNITIES FOR OTHER HARDENING TO BE DONE AT THE SAME TIME AS OTHER CLIMATE-RESILIENCY MEASURES ARE DONE? IS THERE STILL AN OPPORTUNITY TO EXPLORE FINANCING? AND THEN SHOULD WE LOOK AT OTHER APPROACHES AS WELL, IN ADDITION TO THIS? SUCH AS AROUND THE TIME THAT THERE IS A HOME SALE IN ZONES THREE AND FOUR? CAN WE LOOK AT A CONCEPT SIMILAR TO WHAT WE ARE GOING TO BE DISCUSSING LATER TONIGHT WITH BESO? AND HOLD SOME FUNDING IN ESCROW, OR REQUIRE SOME OF IT TO BE HELD IN ESCROW WHILE THESE HARDENING MEASURES ARE BEING DONE? AND LASTLY, ON THE FUNDING QUESTION, AND THIS IS -- I UNDERSTAND FROM SPEAKING TO OUR LEGISLATORS AND OTHERS IN SACRAMENTO, OBVIOUSLY WHAT HAPPENED IN L.A. IS VERY TOP OF MIND RIGHT NOW FOR THE STATE LEGISLATURE. AND THERE'S PROBABLY GOING TO BE LEGISLATION THAT WE SHOULD

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REALLY, AS WE DEVELOP OUR ADVOCACY AGENDA, WE SHOULD TRACK IT AND IF THERE IS FUNDING AVAILABLE THROUGH THOSE SOURCES, WE SHOULD ABSOLUTELY SUPPORT THAT AND THEN IF APPROVED BY THE LEGISLATURE AND SIGNED WE SHOULD TRY TO GO FOR THOSE OPPORTUNITIES. I WAS CURIOUS IF STAFF COULD PUT TOGETHER A SHORT LIST OF WHAT ELSE IS OUT THIS. I HEARD JUST FROM PUBLIC COMMENTS TONIGHT, SAN RAFAEL, SONOMA HAVE DONE CERTAIN THINGS THAT COULD POTENTIALLY BE USED AS MODELS. I HAVE HEARD FROM OTHERS IN THE PUBLIC WHO HAVE WORKED WITH OAKLAND AS MY OWN CHIEF OF STAFF HAS. SHE WAS PREVIOUSLY ASSIGNED TO AN OAKLAND COUNCILMEMBER. SO WHAT OTHER PARTNERSHIP AND COLLABORATION OPPORTUNITIES CAN BE LEVERAGED WITH OAKLAND AND U.C. BERKELEY? I WAS CURIOUS, LOOKING AT THE SUMMARY SLIDES, BETWEEN ESTABLISHMENT AND ADOPTION OF FIRE CODE, BUILDING CODES AND LEAVE EARLY AND STAFFING. IT WOULD BE HELPFUL FOR ME TO SEE AN INTEGRATED TIMELINE FOR EACH OF THOSE PHASES. AND HOW DOES IT RELATE? AND ARE THERE OPPORTUNITIES TO JUST HAVE A BROADLY UNDERSTANDABLE TO THE PUBLIC TIMELINE, I THINK IT WOULD BE HELPFUL FOR US ON THE DAIS AS WELL. WELL, SPEAKING FOR ME, I THINK IT WOULD BE HELPFUL TO SEE ALMOST A GANT CHART OF WHEN CERTAIN PHASES ARE SUPPOSED TO KICK IN. AS WELL AS THE TRANSITION BETWEEN EDUCATION AND ENFORCEMENT FOR EACH OF THESE. AND THEN I'M ALSO CURIOUS IF SOME OF THE BUILDING CODE AMENDMENTS COULD BE LEVERAGED WITH THE NEXT

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TRIENNIAL CYCLE OF TITLE 24 FOR ENERGY UPGRADES? AGAIN, IF THERE MAY BE OPPORTUNITIES TO LEVERAGE THOSE. WE WOULD BE ABLE TO FEED MULTIPLE BIRDS WITH ONE SEED. AND IN A TIME OF SCARCE RESOURCES AND MANY NEEDS, THAT MIGHT BE THE WAY TO GET THROUGH THE BUDGETARY CHALLENGES AND STILL ADOPT THIS. I THINK THOSE ARE ALL OF MY COMMENTS. I KNOW THAT WE PROVIDED ADDITIONAL ONES TO STAFF IN WRITING. AND I'M JUST GOING TO END ON SOMETHING THAT FORMER COUNCILMEMBER AND VICE MAYOR SUSAN WENGRAF SAID AT THE TOP. AND THANK YOU SO MUCH, COUNCILMEMBER WENGRAF, FOR ALL OF YOUR DECADES OF WORK FOR US TO GET TO WHERE WE ARE TONIGHT. THIS WON'T BE EASY. AND IT'S NOT GOING TO BE PERFECT. BUT WE CANNOT AFFORD TO HAVE THE PERFECT BE THE ENEMY OF THE GOOD. AND SO I LOOK FORWARD TO SUPPORTING ALL OF THESE EFFORTS WHEN IT COMES BACK BEFORE US. AND THANK YOU SO MUCH, AGAIN, FOR ALL YOUR HARD WORK ON THIS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. YOU KNOW, THOSE WERE MANY QUESTIONS. AND SO I JUST WANT TO BE SENSITIVE TO THE FACT THAT IT IS 6:18 WHICH MEANS TECHNICALLY OUR COUNCIL MEETING WAS SUPPOSED TO HAVE STARTED 18 MINUTES AGO. IF YOU COULD, AS BRIEFLY AS POSSIBLE RESPOND TO THE QUESTIONS. BUT IF THERE ARE THINGS THAT COULD BE RESPONDED TO LATER, IF YOU ARE OKAY WITH IT, COUNCILMEMBER, PERHAPS STAFF CAN ALSO GET BACK TO YOU WITH SOME OF THOSE ANSWERS THAT MIGHT REQUIRE MORE GRAPHICAL ANSWERS, RESPONSES,

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WOULD THAT BE ALL RIGHT?

>> YEAH, REALLY BRIEFLY, WE ARE HAPPY TO TAKE THOSE RECOMMENDATIONS AND COME BACK WITH THE MATERIALS AND THE PLANS THAT YOU REQUESTED. I THINK THAT MAKES A LOT OF SENSE. IN TERMS OF THE MONEY AVAILABLE THROUGH THE RESIDENCE ASSISTANT PROGRAM, IT'S $2900 PER HOME THAT QUALIFIES, WE SET THAT BASED ON A PILOT WE DID, WE DIDN'T HAVE ANYONE WHO REQUESTED MORE THAN THAT TO IMPLEMENT THE DEFENSIBLE SPACE WORK. THAT'S WHAT IN THE GRANT CURRENTLY THERE'S MONEY AVAILABLE IN MEASURE FF TO SUPPORT THAT PROGRAM. AND WE WILL BE PURSUING ADDITIONAL GRANTS TO SUPPORT HOME HARDENING WORK AS THEY BECOME AVAILABLE. FOLLOWING LEGISLATURE ACTION. I THINK THE REST OF THE QUESTIONS WE CAN ANSWER OFFLINE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANK YOU, ALL. WE ARE MOVING ONTO COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU. I WANT TO FIRST THANK THE FIRE CHIEF AND THE FIRE DEPARTMENT STAFF AND COLLEAGUES FOR ALL OF YOUR HARD WORK AND DILIGENCE ON THIS INCREDIBLY IMPORTANT WORK. AND I'M REALLY EXCITED TO SUPPORT THESE RECOMMENDATIONS, ALL FOUR OF THEM, THANK YOU. I ALSO WANT TO MAKE SURE WE ARE THINKING FULLY ABOUT EVACUATION AND WHAT THAT MEANS FOR A LOT OF OUR RESIDENTS. MANY CAN'T DRIVE OR DON'T HAVE CARS OR ANYWHERE TO EVACUATE TO. WE NEED TO MAKE SURE WE ARE COORDINATING WITH U.C., BERKELEY

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CITY COLLEGE, FAITH CENTERS, TRANSIT CENTERS. AS THE DEVASTATING SITUATION IN L.A. HAS SHOWN US WE CANNOT SEE FIRE SAFETY AS A HILLS ISSUE. IT'S CITYWIDE A REGION WIDE ISSUE WE MUST ALL TAKE SERIOUSLY. BY TAKING THESE RECOMMENDATIONS INTO CONSIDERATION AND EVENTUAL IMPLEMENTATION WE CAN PROTECT OUR CITY AND MAKE SURE OUR RESIDENT HOMES DON'T BECOME FUEL AND SUPPORT EACH OTHER. I SUPPORT THESE EFFORTS AND THANKFUL FOR THE CONVERSATION. THANKS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY, YOURS CAME UP AGAIN, BUT I WANT TO MAKE SURE WE HEAR FROM COUNCILMEMBER TAPLIN AS WELL.

>> B. BLACKABY: I JUST WANT TO MAKE A MOTION WHEN --

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU, I WILL BE SUPPORTING THE PROPOSAL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I JUST HAVE A FEW COMMENTS. I WANT TO MAKE SURE THAT IT'S JUST ON THE RECORD TO SAY THAT AS MAYOR, I THINK IT'S REALLY IMPORTANT THAT I SUPPORT THIS TO SAY IT'S NOT JUST ABOUT THE HILLS, AS WE HAVE BEEN HAVING THESE CONVERSATIONS. FIRE IMPACTS OUR ENTIRE CITY. I WANT TO THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR YOUR WORK. I KNOW THAT AN INCREDIBLE AMOUNT OF TIME AND ENERGY WENT INTO MAKING THIS. I AGREE IT TAKES A LOT OF COURAGE TO BRING THIS FORWARD. I UNDERSTAND IT'S NOT ALWAYS BEEN THIS WAY THAT RESIDENTS HAVE COME IN SUPPORT OF THIS. THANK YOU SO MUCH AND TO MY COUNCILMEMBER COLLEAGUES AS WELL FOR YOUR WORK ON THIS AREA.

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I DO THINK THAT OFTEN TIMES PEOPLE AREN'T WILLING TO MAKE A CHANGE UNTIL IT'S TOO LATE. SO I THINK IT'S VERY IMPORTANT WE ARE DOING THIS WORK NOW. AND I WANT TO SAY THAT, IN A RESPONSE TO A COMMENT THAT WAS MADE EARLIER, I WANT TO MAKE SURE THAT THE ASSET MANAGEMENT KNOWS, I DIDN'T PROMISE THE CITY WAS GOING TO HELP ORGANIZE. OUR OFFICE WILL HELP ORGANIZE GRASSROOTS EFFORTS TO HELP SUPPORT FOLKS WHO AREN'T ABLE TO AFFORD OR DO THE WORK THEMSELVES. THAT'S SOMETHING THAT I'M REALLY INTERESTED IN SUPPORTING. I JUST WANT TO MAKE SURE THAT WAS CLEAR. AND JUST SAY I'M REALLY, REALLY PROUD OF THE WORK WE ARE ALL DOING HERE, IT'S REALLY IMPORTANT FOR OUR CITY. I WILL PASS IT BACK TO YOU, COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY.

>> B. BLACKABY: I WANT TO MAKE A TWO-PART MOTION. THE FIRST IS TO REFER ITEMS 1A, 1B, 1C BACK TO STAFF TO CONDUCT ADDITIONAL COMMUNITY OUTREACH, INCORPORATE ADDITIONAL FEEDBACK, PREPARE FINAL VERSIONS FOR COUNCIL CONSIDERATION IN MARCH. AND THE SECOND PART IS TO ADOPT ITEM 1D WHICH IS IMPLEMENTATION OF THE SAFE PASSAGES PROGRAM.

>> M. HUMBERT: SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ACTUALLY, I THINK ALL OF US HAVE SPOKEN IN SUPPORT. SO IF IT'S OKAY, I CAN HAVE US ALL LISTED AS AYES. UNLESS?

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU. I JUST WANTED TO CLARIFY ON YOUR

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MOTION, WOULD IT BE INCLUSIVE OF INCORPORATING FEEDBACK THAT WE PROVIDED ON THE DAIS?

>> YES, FEEDBACK FROM THE PUBLIC AND COLLEAGUES HERE.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IS THERE ANY OPPOSITION TO HAVING US ALL AS AYES? OKAY, MOTION CARRIES. THANK YOU FOR BEING HERE AND FOR YOUR PRESENTATION. OKAY, SO, FOLKS, I KNOW THAT MANY OF YOU ARE HERE FOR THE MEETING. IT'S 6:23. I JUST WANT TO LET YOU KNOW THAT WE ARE GOING TO TAKE ABOUT A 20-MINUTE BREAK. BECAUSE WE HAVE BEEN SITTING FOR A WHILE. SO MY APOLOGIES TO THOSE OF YOU WHO ARE ALREADY HERE. AND THEN --

>> CITY CLERK: MOTION TO ADJOURN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, WE ALSO NEED A MOTION TO ADJOURN.

>> T. TAPLIN: SO MOVED.

>> I. TREGUB: SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ANY OPPOSITION? ALL RIGHT, WE WILL ALL BE LISTED AS AYES. MOTION TO ADJOURN IS PASSED. WE ARE ADJOURNED. [6:24 P.M.]

Unofficial Text File